ENGLISH FOR WORK / ENGLISH FOR JOINERY, FIT-OUTS, AND CLIENT REVIEWS

Carpentry and Remodeling English

Precise details. Clear agreements.



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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

01 Confirming openings and measurement references, page 4

Identify an unclear measurement reference, correct an assumption, and obtain designer clarification before treating the dimension as usable passage.

02 Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes, page 14

Compare specified material, appearance, profile, and quoted lead time without inventing quality rankings or selecting for the client.

03 Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts, page 26

Identify a drawing conflict precisely, preserve revision and location details, and request clarification without choosing a dimension by convenience.

04 Discussing concealed conditions without guessing, page 36

Describe an exposed condition, explain what cannot be seen, and refer a structural concern without diagnosing concealed timber.

05 Separating requested extras from agreed work, page 48

Explain the agreed task, clarify an additional request, and discuss a separate quotation without implying approval or completion timing.

06 Coordinating access and other trades, page 58

Report delivery, room access, review timing, and storage restrictions as separate arrangements when coordinating with other trades.

07 Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging, page 70

Withdraw an inaccurate overall claim, describe a specific alignment observation, and record follow-up without guessing the remedy.

08 Handing over records and return visits, page 80

Confirm supplied documents, record an undelivered part, and distinguish an accepted callback commitment from an unconfirmed return visit.

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Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

Clarify the detail before it becomes a commitment.

Carpentry conversations connect drawings, materials, people, and site conditions. Precise English identifies the reference behind a dimension, separates observations from diagnoses, and makes clear what is agreed, available, delivered, or still awaiting review.

Name the measurement reference

A number without a reference can be misunderstood. Distinguish an opening dimension, a frame dimension, and usable passage. Ask the designer to resolve an unclear note instead of silently choosing an interpretation.
"The drawing says 900 millimeters, but it does not identify the opening reference."

Compare samples on stated attributes

Material construction, grain, profile, finish, price, and timing are different attributes. Compare only what is known about the actual samples; do not turn one quoted lead time into a universal rule about a material.
"Both match the profile; sample A has pronounced grain and the longer quoted lead time."

Describe the visible condition first

A projecting drawer front and stained subfloor can be described without inventing their cause. Correct inaccurate claims promptly and refer technical assessment to the appropriate person.
"D3 projects at the left edge; I have not assessed the cause or remedy."

Keep dates attached to their purpose

Delivery, access, a review meeting, a callback, and a return visit are separate arrangements. State the owner and status of each instead of compressing them into a single promise.
"Mina will call Friday; the return-visit date is still unconfirmed."

Professional boundaries

All clients, drawings, materials, dimensions, products, prices, schedules, and site conditions in these cases are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not structural assessment, building-code compliance, tool operation, demolition, installation, or legal interpretation. Follow actual project documents, manufacturer instructions, site controls, competent assessments, and applicable requirements. The scenarios do not authorize fabrication from conflicting drawings, entry to unreleased areas, concealed-condition work, substitutions, extra work, or changes to warranty terms.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / CONFIRMING OPENINGS AND MEASUREMENT REFERENCES

Identify an unclear measurement reference, correct an assumption, and obtain designer clarification before treating the dimension as usable passage.

What does 900 millimeters describe?

Client Hana and carpenter Ellis review a hall drawing labeled door opening: 900 millimeters. Hana assumes the figure describes clear passage width. The note does not identify a rough or finished opening, and no door has been ordered. Ellis must clarify the ambiguity without inventing a frame allowance or asserting a usable width. Designer Priya can explain which reference the dimension uses. The conversation concerns interpretation and referral, not a construction method or a compliance decision.

People: Hana, Client; Ellis, Carpenter.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What does the drawing label say?

A. Finished frame allowance confirmed
B. Door opening: 900 millimeters, without a rough or finished reference
C. Clear passage guaranteed at 900 millimeters
D. Door already ordered at a verified size

2. What is Hana assuming?

A. That a door has already arrived
B. That Priya has clarified the note
C. That the frame is not required
D. That 900 millimeters is clear passage width

3. What is the appropriate next step?

A. Certify the opening as compliant
B. Ask Priya to clarify the measurement reference
C. Invent a frame allowance
D. Order a door from the ambiguous note

Answers and explanations, page 107

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

opening dimension
Measurement describing an opening using a stated reference.

clarify the opening dimension

rough opening
Structural opening before the door assembly and relevant finishes are installed.

confirm the rough-opening reference

finished opening
Opening measured at the specified completed surfaces.

identify the finished opening

clear passage
Unobstructed usable space through an opening under the stated conditions.

confirm the clear passage

door leaf
Moving panel of a door.

distinguish the door leaf

door frame
Surrounding assembly supporting and locating the door.

identify the door frame

jamb
Frame member; side jambs and the head jamb identify different positions.

identify the side jamb

head
Upper horizontal member or part of an opening.

identify the frame head

threshold
Lower part at the base of a doorway.

refer to the threshold

casing
Trim around a door or window opening.

identify the casing

architrave
Term commonly used for decorative trim around an opening.

compare the architrave profile

millimeter
Metric unit equal to one thousandth of a meter.

state the dimension in millimeters

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

opening dimension OPENING DIMENSION

clarify the opening dimension

Keep the meaning precise: Measurement describing an opening using a stated reference.

door frame DOOR FRAME

identify the door frame

Keep the meaning precise: Surrounding assembly supporting and locating the door.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

dimension line

Drawing line indicating the extent of a measurement.

follow the dimension line

datum

Stated reference point, line, or level for measurements.

confirm the datum

actual dimension

Measured or specifically defined physical size.

verify the actual dimension

clearance

Space between components or around an operating part.

clarify the required clearance

drawing note

Written instruction or information on a drawing.

clarify the drawing note

order size

Dimensions used to specify a product for purchase.

confirm the order size

reference face

Surface from which a dimension is measured.

identify the reference face

nominal size

Designated size that may differ from an actual measured size.

distinguish nominal size

frame allowance

Space allowed for the specified frame arrangement.

verify the frame allowance

door schedule

Drawing or document listing specified doors and their attributes.

check the door schedule

designer clarification

Explanation from the responsible design professional.

request designer clarification

dimension reference

Point, surface, or condition a measurement describes.

establish the dimension reference

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

millimeter MILLIMETER

state the dimension in millimeters

Keep the meaning precise: Metric unit equal to one thousandth of a meter.

actual dimension ACTUAL DIMENSION

verify the actual dimension

Keep the meaning precise: Measured or specifically defined physical size.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Locate the note

The hall drawing labels the door opening as 900 millimeters.

Name the ambiguity

The note does not say rough or finished opening.

Ask about the reference

What surfaces does this dimension run between?

Avoid inventing an allowance

We do not have a confirmed frame allowance here.

Refer the interpretation

Priya can clarify the measurement reference.

Distinguish product size

We should not treat this as the order size yet.

Preserve the client need

I will explain that your question concerns usable passage.

Read back the query

Does 900 refer to the rough opening, finished opening, or another reference?

Clarify the assumption

Are you reading that as the clear passage width?

Explain the distinction

The opening reference and the usable passage are not necessarily the same.

Keep the number intact

I am not changing the figure of 900 millimeters.

Preserve the order status

No door has been ordered.

Avoid a usable-width promise

I cannot confirm 900 millimeters of clear passage from this note.

Ask for explicit wording

Could the clarification identify the opening type?

Avoid a compliance claim

This conversation does not establish compliance.

Close with the next step

I will request clarification before presenting the dimension as a confirmed usable width.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Explain the distinction
Useful wording: The opening reference and the usable passage are not necessarily the same.

Purpose: Ask about the reference
Useful wording: What surfaces does this dimension run between?

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which question targets the missing information?

A. Does 900 millimeters refer to the rough opening, finished opening, or another reference?

B. Can we subtract an assumed frame width from 900?

C. Does 900 refer to the door leaf already selected?

D. Can we call 900 the usable width until someone objects?

2. Which reassurance is unsupported?

A. No door is ordered.

B. Priya can clarify the reference.

C. You will definitely have 900 millimeters of usable passage.

D. The note gives a 900-millimeter figure.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Unobstructed usable space through an opening under the stated conditions. Which term fits?

A. datum

B. clear passage

C. threshold

D. drawing note

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "What does 900 millimeters describe?". Hana: "When you say rough, do you mean the measurement isn't accurate? I'd prefer an exact figure before we choose anything." Ellis: [missing response] Hana: "I see. So which surfaces does this particular arrow measure between? The drawing isn't clear enough for me to tell." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I'll request designer clarification from Priya and include your question about walking through the doorway. She needs both the note and the practical concern.

B. That's the missing reference face information. We need the surfaces identified; subtracting a guessed allowance could give you a very misleading answer.

C. You're asking about clear passage. It's a different question from the door's size, and the note doesn't establish that usable width.

D. No, rough opening describes the structural opening before the assembly and relevant finishes. Rough names a construction stage here, not a rough guess.

Answers and explanations, page 107

One useful distinction

The only established figure is 900 millimeters in an unclear opening note. Rough opening, finished opening, door size, and clear passage are not interchangeable labels. No conversion or allowance is supplied, and no door has been ordered.

E Conversation

What does 900 millimeters describe?

What does 900 millimeters describe?

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

dimension reference / order size / actual dimension / designer clarification / drawing note / clear passage / opening dimension / reference face / rough opening / door frame

01 **Hana:** Before we order the hall door, can I check this 900-millimeter note? I'm expecting that much space to walk through with the door open.

02 **Ellis:** The [1] _____ is missing. It says door opening, but doesn't identify a rough opening, finished opening, or another measurement. I can't promise the walking space from that.

03 **Hana:** Right, I'm interested in the gap I can actually use, not the width of the door leaf. Have I been reading the wrong measurement?

04 **Ellis:** You're asking about [2] _____. It's a different question from the door's size, and the note doesn't establish that usable width.

05 **Hana:** When you say rough, do you mean the measurement isn't accurate? I'd prefer an exact figure before we choose anything.

06 **Ellis:** No, [3] _____ describes the structural opening before the assembly and relevant finishes. Rough names a construction stage here, not a rough guess.

07 **Hana:** I see. So which surfaces does this particular arrow measure between? The drawing isn't clear enough for me to tell.

08 **Ellis:** That's the missing [4] _____ information. We need the surfaces identified; subtracting a guessed allowance could give you a very misleading answer.

09 **Hana:** Has anyone already bought a door against that number? I'd rather raise it now than discover it doesn't give us the passage we need.

10 **Ellis:** No door is ordered, and the [5] _____ isn't confirmed. We're clarifying the drawing before purchasing, not changing an existing order.

Conversation continues on the next page.

What does 900 millimeters describe?

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Hana:** Can Priya settle the meaning? She prepared the design, and I'd like her to understand why I'm asking about the space.

12 **Ellis:** I'll request [6] _____ from Priya and include your question about walking through the doorway. She needs both the note and the practical concern.

13 **Hana:** Please don't change 900 to a different number in the message. I'm asking what it means, not instructing her to redesign it.

14 **Ellis:** Agreed. I'll quote the [7] _____ of 900 millimeters exactly and ask which construction stage and measurement surfaces it refers to.

15 **Hana:** Would the frame take some of that space? I'm not asking you to work it out now, but I don't want it overlooked.

16 **Ellis:** The [8] _____ is a separate component to consider. Its dimensions aren't supplied here, so I won't invent a thickness or a resulting clear width.

17 **Hana:** And we're not confirming that the doorway meets a particular access requirement today? I don't want to pass that on as settled.

18 **Ellis:** Correct. Resolving the [9] _____ isn't a compliance assessment. We'll keep that distinction clear when we pass the question to Priya.

19 **Hana:** Then the message is: what does 900 measure, and what usable passage will this arrangement give? No order until the reference is resolved.

20 **Ellis:** Yes. The [10] _____ of that passage remains unverified. I'll send the query with the original note, without promising a width or a product size.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. dimension reference / **2.** clear passage / **3.** rough opening / **4.** reference face / **5.** order size / **6.** designer clarification / **7.** opening dimension / **8.** door frame / **9.** drawing note / **10.** actual dimension

Why these answers fit, page 108

F Check accuracy and scope

What does 900 millimeters describe?

Return to the case

Client Hana and carpenter Ellis review a hall drawing labeled door opening: 900 millimeters. Hana assumes the figure describes clear passage width. The note does not identify a rough or finished opening, and no door has been ordered. Ellis must clarify the ambiguity without inventing a frame allowance or asserting a usable width. Designer Priya can explain which reference the dimension uses. The conversation concerns interpretation and referral, not a construction method or a compliance decision.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What should remain unchanged in the query?

A. A fabricated confirmed order size
B. A claim that the drawing means finished opening
C. The stated 900-millimeter figure and the uncertainty about its reference
D. A guessed frame deduction

2. Which distinction matters for ordering?

A. Client interpretation automatically authorizes an order.
B. A precise number removes every need for clarification.
C. An unclear opening note is not a confirmed door order size.
D. All opening and door dimensions are identical.

Answers and explanations, page 110

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20; quote 900 exactly and keep Priya's clarification separate from a width guarantee.

A precise number can still carry an unclear meaning

A client may reasonably read an opening dimension as the space available to pass through. Acknowledge that interpretation, explain the missing reference in ordinary words, and ask the designer to clarify it. Do not make uncertainty sound like a mistake the client should have recognized.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Clarify before naming the usable width

Complete the exchange about the hall drawing. Keep the given number, missing reference, unverified passage, and designer referral distinct.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

passage / 900 / finished / designer

01 **Client:** The drawing says [1] _____ millimeters.

02 **Carpenter:** The note does not identify rough or [2] _____ opening.

03 **Client:** My concern is the clear [3] _____.

04 **Carpenter:** I will ask the [4] _____ to clarify the reference.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 900 / **2.** finished / **3.** passage / **4.** designer

Why these answers fit, page 110

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "What does 900 millimeters describe?". Hana: "Please don't change 900 to a different number in the message. I'm asking what it means, not instructing her to redesign it." Ellis: [missing response] Hana: "Would the frame take some of that space? I'm not asking you to work it out now, but I don't want it overlooked." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Agreed. I'll quote the opening dimension of 900 millimeters exactly and ask which construction stage and measurement surfaces it refers to.

B. Correct. Resolving the drawing note isn't a compliance assessment. We'll keep that distinction clear when we pass the question to Priya.

C. You're asking about clear passage. It's a different question from the door's size, and the note doesn't establish that usable width.

D. No door is ordered, and the order size isn't confirmed. We're clarifying the drawing before purchasing, not changing an existing order.

Answers and explanations, page 111

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / SELECTING TIMBER, TRIM, AND VISIBLE FINISHES

Compare specified material, appearance, profile, and quoted lead time without inventing quality rankings or selecting for the client.

Two oak samples, different trade-offs

For a study remodel, carpenter Mei compares two trim samples with client Oliver. Sample A is solid oak with pronounced grain and a quoted ten-day lead time. Sample B is oak-veneered trim with a more uniform appearance and a quoted four-day lead time. Both match the requested profile. No sample is selected, and no price comparison, durability ranking, or installation date is supplied. Mei must keep the comparison tied to these samples rather than generalize about every solid or veneered product.

People: Oliver, Client; Mei, Carpenter.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which description belongs to sample A?

A. Plastic trim, no grain, immediate delivery
B. A selected product with a confirmed installation date
C. Solid oak, pronounced grain, ten-day quoted lead time
D. Oak veneer, uniform appearance, four days

2. What do the samples have in common?

A. Both have identical grain appearance
B. Both have already been selected
C. Both match the requested profile
D. Both have the same quoted lead time

3. What remains undecided?

A. Which sample to select
B. Whether B has the shorter quoted lead time
C. Whether A is solid oak
D. Whether both match the profile

Answers and explanations, page 112

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

solid oak
Material made from oak wood rather than an oak surface veneer over a core.

specify solid oak trim

oak veneer
Thin oak layer applied over a supporting material.

identify the oak veneer

veneered trim
Trim with a veneer surface over a core.

compare veneered trim

timber
Wood prepared or used for building and joinery.

specify the timber

trim
Finishing material used at edges, joints, or decorative features.

compare the trim samples

profile
Cross-sectional shape of a trim piece or molding.

match the requested profile

grain
Visible pattern associated with the wood's structure.

compare the grain

pronounced grain
Strongly visible wood pattern.

describe pronounced grain

uniform appearance
More consistent visual character across the sample.

describe a uniform appearance

core material
Supporting material beneath a surface layer.

identify the core material

face veneer
Veneer on the visible face of a product.

specify the face veneer

edge treatment
Way the edge of a component is finished or covered.

clarify the edge treatment

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

solid oak SOLID OAK

specify solid oak trim

Keep the meaning precise: Material made from oak wood rather than an oak surface veneer over a core.

profile PROFILE

match the requested profile

Keep the meaning precise: Cross-sectional shape of a trim piece or molding.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

finish sample

Example showing a proposed surface appearance.

review the finish sample

sheen

Degree of surface reflectivity.

compare the sheen

clear finish

Coating that allows underlying material to remain visible.

specify a clear finish

opaque finish

Coating that hides the underlying material's appearance.

distinguish an opaque finish

stain

Coloring treatment used to change wood's appearance.

clarify the stain color

quoted lead time

Supply interval stated in a quotation or proposal.

compare quoted lead times

selection status

Whether a choice has been made.

confirm the selection status

material construction

How a product is made up of its constituent materials.

compare material construction

visual preference

Appearance favored by the client.

clarify the visual preference

sample approval

Acceptance of a particular reference sample.

record sample approval

performance claim

Statement about how a product will function or endure.

avoid an unsupported performance claim

installation date

Scheduled day for fitting work at the site.

confirm the installation date

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

edge treatment EDGE TREATMENT

clarify the edge treatment

Keep the meaning precise: Way the edge of a component is finished or covered.

stain STAIN

clarify the stain color

Keep the meaning precise: Coloring treatment used to change wood's appearance.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Open the comparison

Both samples match the requested profile.

Describe B's construction

Sample B is oak-veneered trim.

Describe B's appearance

B has a more uniform appearance.

State B's timing

B has a quoted four-day lead time.

Avoid a price inference

We do not have a price comparison here.

Preserve the shared feature

The profile is not the difference between them.

Separate discussion and selection

Discussing A does not mean you have selected it.

Preserve the decision status

No sample is selected yet.

Describe A's construction

Sample A is solid oak.

Describe A's appearance

A has more pronounced grain.

State A's timing

A has a quoted ten-day lead time.

Make a bounded comparison

B has the shorter quoted lead time for these two samples.

Avoid a quality ranking

The material names alone do not establish which will perform better.

Clarify the preference

Is the more visible grain the appearance you prefer?

Keep the date distinction

A quoted lead time is not an installation appointment.

Summarize the trade-off

The known differences are construction, appearance, and quoted lead time.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Describe A's appearance
Useful wording: A has more pronounced grain.

Purpose: Describe B's appearance
Useful wording: B has a more uniform appearance.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which comparison is fully supported?

A. A is booked for installation in ten days.

B. A is solid oak with pronounced grain and ten days; B is veneered with a more uniform look and four days.

C. A is cheaper and B is stronger.

D. B always lasts longer than solid oak.

2. Which attribute does not distinguish the samples?

A. The requested profile, which both match

B. Solid versus veneered construction

C. Pronounced versus more uniform appearance

D. Ten versus four quoted days

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Wood prepared or used for building and joinery. Which term fits?

A. uniform appearance

B. timber

C. visual preference

D. clear finish

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two oak samples, different trade-offs". Oliver: "So B has real oak on the surface, over something else? What is underneath it, or don't we have that specification here?" Mei: [missing response] Oliver: "Remind me which one has the shorter lead time. I don't want to mistake a supplier quote for the day you'll fit it." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes, oak veneer refers to that surface layer. I do not have a specification for the supporting material here, so I should not name a core that is not listed.

B. There is a difference in material construction. Sample A is solid oak, while sample B is oak-veneered trim. Both match the profile you requested for the study.

C. Correct, and neither quote is an installation date. Both match the profile, no sample is selected, and the other details remain to be confirmed before a decision.

D. We can keep those as separate questions before sample approval. Nothing in this discussion establishes a finish specification, a price, or a guarantee about future product performance.

Answers and explanations, page 112

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Sample A has pronounced grain and a ten-day quoted lead time. Sample B has a more uniform appearance and a four-day quote. Both match the profile. These are sample-specific facts, not universal claims about solid oak and veneered products.

E Conversation

Two oak samples, different trade-offs

Two oak samples, different trade-offs

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

performance claim / material construction / oak veneer / profile / visual preference / quoted lead time / selection status / sample approval / pronounced grain / installation date

01 **Oliver:** Both shapes look right for the study. Before I choose, what is actually different between these samples apart from the price, which I haven't seen?

02 **Mei:** There is a difference in [1] _____. Sample A is solid oak, while sample B is oak-veneered trim. Both match the profile you requested for the study.

03 **Oliver:** A's grain stands out much more against this wall color. B looks quieter. Is that just what we're seeing in these particular pieces?

04 **Mei:** A has [2] _____, and B has a more uniform appearance. Those are the visual differences stated for these samples, not a ranking of quality.

05 **Oliver:** So B has real oak on the surface, over something else? What is underneath it, or don't we have that specification here?

06 **Mei:** Yes, [3] _____ refers to that surface layer. I do not have a specification for the supporting material here, so I should not name a core that is not listed.

07 **Oliver:** Remind me which one has the shorter lead time. I don't want to mistake a supplier quote for the day you'll fit it.

08 **Mei:** The [4] _____ is ten days for A and four days for B. Those are supply quotes, not confirmed installation appointments.

09 **Oliver:** That makes B six days quicker on the quote. I still prefer A's grain, so I'm not ready to choose on timing alone.

10 **Mei:** Exactly. Your [5] _____ and the timing are separate considerations. We can compare them without deciding that one sample is better in every respect.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Two oak samples, different trade-offs

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Oliver:** And I wouldn't lose this edge shape by choosing B? The study trim needs the profile we've already discussed.

12 **Mei:** Both match the requested [6] _____. The known differences here are construction, grain appearance, and quoted lead time, not the shape you specified.

13 **Oliver:** Do we have prices or durability information yet? I don't want to assume veneered automatically means cheaper or less hard-wearing.

14 **Mei:** We do not have a price comparison. I also cannot support a [7] _____ about which lasts longer from the information on these two samples.

15 **Oliver:** I'm leaning toward A, but please don't order it on that basis. I still need the missing details before I approve anything.

16 **Mei:** I will keep the [8] _____ open. We can note your interest in A without recording it as an approved sample or a placed order.

17 **Oliver:** Can you keep the finish details and prices as outstanding questions? They matter to the decision as well as the grain and lead time.

18 **Mei:** We can keep those as separate questions before [9] _____. Nothing in this discussion establishes a finish specification, a price, or a guarantee about future product performance.

19 **Oliver:** Let me read that back: A, solid oak, stronger grain, ten days; B, veneered, more uniform, four days. Neither has an installation booking.

20 **Mei:** Correct, and neither quote is an [10] _____. Both match the profile, no sample is selected, and the other details remain to be confirmed before a decision.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. material construction / **2.** pronounced grain / **3.** oak veneer / **4.** quoted lead time / **5.** visual preference / **6.** profile / **7.** performance claim / **8.** selection status / **9.** sample approval / **10.** installation date

Why these answers fit, page 113

F Check accuracy and scope

Two oak samples, different trade-offs

Return to the case

For a study remodel, carpenter Mei compares two trim samples with client Oliver. Sample A is solid oak with pronounced grain and a quoted ten-day lead time. Sample B is oak-veneered trim with a more uniform appearance and a quoted four-day lead time. Both match the requested profile. No sample is selected, and no price comparison, durability ranking, or installation date is supplied. Mei must keep the comparison tied to these samples rather than generalize about every solid or veneered product.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which statement overgeneralizes?

A. A is quoted at ten days.
B. Neither sample is selected.
C. Veneered trim always arrives in four days.
D. B is quoted at four days.

2. How should Mei record Oliver's interest in A?

A. A is under discussion; no selection has been made.
B. A has been purchased and installed.
C. Both samples are rejected.
D. B is approved because it is quicker.

Answers and explanations, page 115

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20; separate matching profile from price, performance, and approval.

Compare attributes without selling an unsupported conclusion

A client may ask which product is better when the real choice involves several preferences. Compare the known attributes side by side and clarify the selection status. Avoid implying that a shorter quoted lead time means better quality or that a material name establishes every performance characteristic.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Compare without choosing for the client

Complete the sample comparison. Use the stated construction, appearance, lead time, and decision status; do not add prices or durability claims.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

oak / four / selected / uniform

01 **Carpenter:** Sample A is solid [1] _____.

02 **Client:** B has the more [2] _____ appearance.

03 **Carpenter:** B has a quoted [3] _____-day lead time.

04 **Client:** Neither sample is [4] _____ yet.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. oak / **2.** uniform / **3.** four / **4.** selected

Why these answers fit, page 115

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two oak samples, different trade-offs". Oliver: "Do we have prices or durability information yet? I don't want to assume veneered automatically means cheaper or less hard-wearing." Mei: [missing response] Oliver: "I'm leaning toward A, but please don't order it on that basis. I still need the missing details before I approve anything." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will keep the selection status open. We can note your interest in A without recording it as an approved sample or a placed order.

B. Exactly. Your visual preference and the timing are separate considerations. We can compare them without deciding that one sample is better in every respect.

C. We do not have a price comparison. I also cannot support a performance claim about which lasts longer from the information on these two samples.

D. A has pronounced grain, and B has a more uniform appearance. Those are the visual differences stated for these samples, not a ranking of quality.

Answers and explanations, page 116

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Confirming openings and measurement references" and "Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Opening measured at the specified completed surfaces. Which term fits?

A. finished opening

B. reference face

C. head

D. door schedule

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Strongly visible wood pattern. Which term fits?

A. pronounced grain

B. solid oak

C. finish sample

D. selection status

3. Rebuild the exchange from "What does 900 millimeters describe?". Hana: "Has anyone already bought a door against that number? I'd rather raise it now than discover it doesn't give us the passage we need." Ellis: [missing response] Hana: "Can Priya settle the meaning? She prepared the design, and I'd like her to understand why I'm asking about the space." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No door is ordered, and the order size isn't confirmed. We're clarifying the drawing before purchasing, not changing an existing order.

B. Correct. Resolving the drawing note isn't a compliance assessment. We'll keep that distinction clear when we pass the question to Priya.

C. You're asking about clear passage. It's a different question from the door's size, and the note doesn't establish that usable width.

D. Agreed. I'll quote the opening dimension of 900 millimeters exactly and ask which construction stage and measurement surfaces it refers to.

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two oak samples, different trade-offs". Oliver: "Can you keep the finish details and prices as outstanding questions? They matter to the decision as well as the grain and lead time." Mei: [missing response] Oliver: "Let me read that back: A, solid oak, stronger grain, ten days; B, veneered, more uniform, four days. Neither has an installation booking." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. A has pronounced grain, and B has a more uniform appearance. Those are the visual differences stated for these samples, not a ranking of quality.

B. We can keep those as separate questions before sample approval. Nothing in this discussion establishes a finish specification, a price, or a guarantee about future product performance.

C. There is a difference in material construction. Sample A is solid oak, while sample B is oak-veneered trim. Both match the profile you requested for the study.

D. Correct, and neither quote is an installation date. Both match the profile, no sample is selected, and the other details remain to be confirmed before a decision.

Answers and explanations, page 147

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / READING DETAILS AND RESOLVING DRAWING CONFLICTS

Identify a drawing conflict precisely, preserve revision and location details, and request clarification without choosing a dimension by convenience.

> **Two reveals on revision B**
>
> Carpenter Arun and coordinator Lena review cabinet drawings before a fabrication-release review due at 14:00. Elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal at an end panel. Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters at the same panel. The designer has not clarified which dimension applies. Both sheets carry the same revision letter, so the team cannot resolve the discrepancy by assuming one is a later issue. No dimension is authorized through this conversation.

People: Arun, Carpenter; Lena, Project coordinator.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What conflict is shown?

A. C4 revision B gives 20 millimeters; S2 revision B gives 15 at the same panel
B. C4 gives 15 and S2 gives 20 at different rooms
C. Both drawings give 20
D. One drawing is revision C

2. What is due at 14:00?

A. The fabrication-release review
B. Guaranteed installation completion
C. A confirmed designer reply
D. Delivery of all cabinets

3. Who has not yet clarified the dimension?

A. The designer
B. A customer who already approved 20
C. A fabricator who already approved 15
D. A supplier who changed the drawings

Answers and explanations, page 117

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

elevation
Drawing view showing a face of an object or building.

read the cabinet elevation

section
Drawing view representing a cut through an object or assembly.

compare the section

reveal
Defined visible gap or exposed setback between adjacent components.

confirm the reveal dimension

end panel
Panel forming or covering an exposed end of cabinetry.

identify the end panel

revision
Identified issue or update of a drawing or document.

verify the revision

drawing conflict
Inconsistent information between relevant drawings.

flag a drawing conflict

dimension discrepancy
Difference between dimensions that should describe the same detail.

report a dimension discrepancy

fabrication
Manufacture of components or assemblies.

clarify before fabrication

release review
Review of readiness or permission to issue work for the next stage.

attend the release review

shop drawing
Detailed production or installation drawing for a specific assembly.

review the shop drawing

detail reference
Identifier pointing to a particular drawing detail.

include the detail reference

sheet number
Identifier of a drawing sheet.

quote the sheet number

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

elevation ELEVATION

read the cabinet elevation

Keep the meaning precise: Drawing view showing a face of an object or building.

drawing conflict DRAWING CONFLICT

flag a drawing conflict

Keep the meaning precise: Inconsistent information between relevant drawings.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

revision cloud
Drawing mark identifying an area of change.
locate the revision cloud

superseded drawing
Earlier drawing replaced by a later authorized issue.
identify a superseded drawing

design intent
Intended design result communicated through the project information.
clarify the design intent

request for information
Formal or recorded query seeking missing or unclear project information.
submit a request for information

clarification response
Reply resolving a stated information question.
await the clarification response

applicable dimension
Measurement confirmed as relevant to the detail.
verify the applicable dimension

fabrication release
Authorization or controlled issue allowing production to proceed.
confirm fabrication release

review deadline
Time by which a review is due.
state the review deadline

unresolved detail
Information point not yet clarified.
flag an unresolved detail

cross-reference
Link between related drawing views or documents.
check the cross-reference

kerf
Width of material removed by a cut, distinct from blade plate thickness.
allow for the kerf

cut list
List of required parts, quantities, and finished dimensions.
review the cut list

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

sheet number SHEET NUMBER

quote the sheet number

Keep the meaning precise: Identifier of a drawing sheet.

clarification response CLARIFICATION RESPONSE

await the clarification response

Keep the meaning precise: Reply resolving a stated information question.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Flag the issue
I found a conflict at the cabinet end panel.

Cite the first view
Elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal.

Cite the second view
Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters.

Confirm the shared location
Both dimensions refer to the same end panel.

Check the issue labels
Both sheets are marked revision B.

State the difference
The values differ by five millimeters.

Reject a revision shortcut
We cannot identify a newer sheet from those labels alone.

Name the missing answer
The designer has not clarified which dimension applies.

Request a decision
Please confirm the applicable reveal dimension.

Preserve the review time
The fabrication-release review is due at 14:00.

Avoid a response promise
That review time is not a guaranteed designer-response time.

Keep production status separate
The conflict discussion does not authorize fabrication.

Keep both references
I will include C4 and S2 in the query.

Avoid averaging
I will not use the midpoint as an invented solution.

Ask for an explicit response
The reply needs to identify the dimension for this panel.

Close with the current status
The detail remains unresolved pending clarification.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Confirm the shared location
Useful wording: Both dimensions refer to the same end panel.

Purpose: Check the issue labels
Useful wording: Both sheets are marked revision B.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which query is complete?

A. At the same end panel, C4 rev B shows 20 mm and S2 rev B shows 15 mm; please clarify for the 14:00 release review.

B. Please confirm 20 mm on C4 without mentioning S2.

C. Use 15 mm because the section must take precedence.

D. Release at 17.5 mm as a compromise between the views.

2. Which proposed shortcut is unsupported?

A. Average the values and fabricate a 17.5-millimeter reveal.

B. Ask the designer to clarify.

C. Preserve both revision labels.

D. Flag the unresolved detail for review.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Panel forming or covering an exposed end of cabinetry. Which term fits?

A. unresolved detail

B. end panel

C. design intent

D. release review

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two reveals on revision B". Arun: "Still waiting. The workshop has asked which figure to use. I can't choose twenty just because the elevation is the clearer view." Lena: [missing response] Arun: "Someone thought S2 might be the old sheet. Both labels say B, though, and I haven't found anything establishing that either has been replaced." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Agreed. The applicable dimension is the reveal at this location. A precise query doesn't imply we've verified the rest of the package.

B. That's a five-millimeter dimension discrepancy. Has the designer answered it in a separate message, or are we still waiting for the intended reveal?

C. Then don't mark it a superseded drawing. Matching revision letters don't resolve a conflict or tell us that the elevation takes precedence.

D. Nor can we choose fifteen for convenience. We need a clarification response identifying the intended value and the detail it applies to.

Answers and explanations, page 117

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The difference is five millimeters, but calculating that difference does not identify the correct reveal. Both C4 and S2 are revision B and refer to the same panel. Neither sheet is established as superseded or authoritative over the other.

E Conversation

Two reveals on revision B

Two reveals on revision B

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

sheet number / drawing conflict / fabrication release / superseded drawing / dimension discrepancy / design intent / unresolved detail / review deadline / applicable dimension / clarification response

01 **Arun:** Lena, can we stop on the end-panel detail before the release review? The elevation and section give different reveals at the same panel.

02 **Lena:** Give me each [1] _____ and revision, please. I want the designer to find the conflict without having to guess which cabinet we're discussing.

03 **Arun:** Elevation C4, revision B: twenty millimeters. Section S2, also revision B: fifteen. I've checked that they point to this same end panel.

04 **Lena:** That's a five-millimeter [2] _____. Has the designer answered it in a separate message, or are we still waiting for the intended reveal?

05 **Arun:** Still waiting. The workshop has asked which figure to use. I can't choose twenty just because the elevation is the clearer view.

06 **Lena:** Nor can we choose fifteen for convenience. We need a [3] _____ identifying the intended value and the detail it applies to.

07 **Arun:** Someone thought S2 might be the old sheet. Both labels say B, though, and I haven't found anything establishing that either has been replaced.

08 **Lena:** Then don't mark it a [4] _____. Matching revision letters don't resolve a conflict or tell us that the elevation takes precedence.

09 **Arun:** The fabrication-release review is at fourteen hundred. Can the query say that, so the designer understands the timing without reading the whole schedule?

10 **Lena:** I'll include the [5] _____. It's the review time, not a promised response time, and it doesn't give us permission to pick a dimension.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Two reveals on revision B

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Arun:** Put both values in the actual question, please. If the message just says end-panel query, it may come back asking for the missing numbers.

12 **Lena:** I'll state the [6] _____ in one sentence: C4 rev B shows twenty, S2 rev B shows fifteen, at the same end panel.

13 **Arun:** And ask specifically for the reveal. I don't want this turned into a request to recheck every dimension in the cabinet package.

14 **Lena:** Agreed. The [7] _____ is the reveal at this location. A precise query doesn't imply we've verified the rest of the package.

15 **Arun:** If the answer hasn't arrived by the review, what goes in the record? Leaving the box empty could make it look resolved.

16 **Lena:** Record an [8] _____, with the query reference. No reply is not approval of either figure, and the conflicting values must remain visible.

17 **Arun:** The other suggestion was seventeen and a half, splitting the difference. That would keep everyone moving, but it's not on either drawing.

18 **Lena:** Averaging isn't [9] _____. Seventeen and a half would be a third, invented dimension, not a resolution of the two we were given.

19 **Arun:** Understood. I'll bring both sheets to the fourteen-hundred review and keep the reveal outstanding. Can you send the specific question now?

20 **Lena:** Yes. The query doesn't grant [10] _____. I'll preserve both references, values, and the unresolved status so the release decision isn't based on an assumption.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. sheet number / **2.** dimension discrepancy / **3.** clarification response / **4.** superseded drawing / **5.** review deadline / **6.** drawing conflict / **7.** applicable dimension / **8.** unresolved detail / **9.** design intent / **10.** fabrication release

Why these answers fit, page 118

F Check accuracy and scope

Two reveals on revision B

Return to the case

Carpenter Arun and coordinator Lena review cabinet drawings before a fabrication-release review due at 14:00. Elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal at an end panel. Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters at the same panel. The designer has not clarified which dimension applies. Both sheets carry the same revision letter, so the team cannot resolve the discrepancy by assuming one is a later issue. No dimension is authorized through this conversation.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What do the revision labels establish?

A. S2 is superseded
B. The reveal is automatically 20
C. Both sheets are marked B, not which dimension is correct
D. C4 is definitely newer

2. Which status is accurate at the end?

A. The designer has approved 15.
B. The review deadline authorizes 20.
C. Installation is complete.
D. The reveal remains unresolved and fabrication is not authorized by this conversation.

Answers and explanations, page 120

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress unresolved and keep the 14:00 review distinct from release.

Make a conflict easy to answer

A useful clarification request contains both drawing references, their revisions, the exact location, and the conflicting values. Include the review deadline as a coordination fact, not a reason to guess. Shared revision labels do not make incompatible dimensions agree.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Refer the conflicting detail

Complete the drawing query using both references and values. Keep the shared revision and the unresolved status intact.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

clarified / panel / C4 / 15

01 **Carpenter:** Elevation [1] _____ revision B shows 20 millimeters.

02 **Coordinator:** Section S2 revision B shows [2] _____ millimeters.

03 **Carpenter:** Both refer to the same end [3] _____.

04 **Coordinator:** The designer has not yet [4] _____ the applicable dimension.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. C4 / **2.** 15 / **3.** panel / **4.** clarified

Why these answers fit, page 120

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two reveals on revision B". Arun: "And ask specifically for the reveal. I don't want this turned into a request to recheck every dimension in the cabinet package." Lena: [missing response] Arun: "If the answer hasn't arrived by the review, what goes in the record? Leaving the box empty could make it look resolved." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Then don't mark it a superseded drawing. Matching revision letters don't resolve a conflict or tell us that the elevation takes precedence.

B. That's a five-millimeter dimension discrepancy. Has the designer answered it in a separate message, or are we still waiting for the intended reveal?

C. Nor can we choose fifteen for convenience. We need a clarification response identifying the intended value and the detail it applies to.

D. Agreed. The applicable dimension is the reveal at this location. A precise query doesn't imply we've verified the rest of the package.

Answers and explanations, page 121

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / DISCUSSING CONCEALED CONDITIONS WITHOUT GUESSING

Describe an exposed condition, explain what cannot be seen, and refer a structural concern without diagnosing concealed timber.

> **Staining is not a structural finding**
>
> At a laundry remodel, client Theo notices dark staining on exposed subfloor beside the laundry doorway. He asks carpenter Nia whether the joists are rotten. The joists are not visible, and Nia has not assessed structural condition. Project lead Sam can arrange a qualified assessment. Nia must describe the visible staining and the limits of her knowledge without confirming decay, declaring the structure sound, identifying a cause, or promising a repair.

People: Theo, Client; Nia, Carpenter.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is visible?

A. A verified leak source
B. Dark staining on exposed subfloor beside the laundry doorway
C. Rotten joists confirmed by assessment
D. Repaired structural members

2. What limits Nia's conclusion?

A. A completed assessment proves no concern
B. The client has already supplied a diagnosis
C. Every concealed member has been inspected
D. The joists are not visible and structural condition has not been assessed

3. What can Sam arrange?

A. A finding that the structure is sound
B. A qualified assessment
C. A repair already completed
D. A guaranteed replacement price

Answers and explanations, page 122

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

subfloor
Supporting floor layer beneath the finished floor covering.

describe the exposed subfloor

joist
Structural member supporting a floor or ceiling over a span.

refer to the concealed joists

floor covering
Visible finish material laid over the floor base.

distinguish the floor covering

exposed surface
Area visible after a covering is absent or removed.

describe the exposed surface

concealed condition
State of material or construction hidden from view.

refer a concealed-condition concern

dark staining
Visible discoloration with a dark appearance.

report dark staining

discoloration
Change in the apparent color of a surface.

describe the discoloration

timber decay
Deterioration of wood through biological action.

avoid diagnosing timber decay

structural condition
State of components relevant to carrying loads.

request assessment of structural condition

load-bearing member
Component intended to support structural loads.

identify the load-bearing member

moisture source
Origin of water or dampness affecting an area.

investigate the moisture source

water ingress
Entry of water into an area or construction.

report a concern about water ingress

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

subfloor SUBFLOOR

describe the exposed subfloor

Keep the meaning precise: Supporting floor layer beneath the finished floor covering.

dark staining DARK STAINING

report dark staining

Keep the meaning precise: Visible discoloration with a dark appearance.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

inspection access
Ability to reach or view an area for examination.
confirm inspection access

qualified assessor
Person competent to examine the relevant condition.
refer to a qualified assessor

site observation
Condition directly noticed at the location.
record a site observation

structural finding
Conclusion reached through appropriate structural assessment.
distinguish a structural finding

investigation status
Current stage of checking an unresolved concern.
report the investigation status

condition report
Record describing an examined or observed state.
prepare an accurate condition report

visibility limit
Boundary of what can actually be seen.
explain the visibility limit

assessment scope
Matters included in a specified examination.
confirm the assessment scope

unsupported diagnosis
Conclusion about a problem without adequate assessment.
avoid an unsupported diagnosis

repair proposal
Suggested work to address an established issue.
await a repair proposal

laundry doorway
Opening at the entrance to the laundry area.
locate the laundry doorway

referral route
Process for passing a concern to the appropriate person.
explain the referral route

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

water ingress WATER INGRESS

report a concern about water ingress

Keep the meaning precise: Entry of water into an area or construction.

site observation SITE OBSERVATION

record a site observation

Keep the meaning precise: Condition directly noticed at the location.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Name the observation
I can see dark staining on the exposed subfloor.

Locate it precisely
It is beside the laundry doorway.

Acknowledge the concern
I understand why you are asking about the joists.

State the visibility limit
The joists are not visible here.

State the assessment limit
I have not assessed the structural condition.

Avoid a diagnosis
I cannot confirm that the joists are rotten.

Avoid false reassurance
I cannot declare them sound from this view either.

Keep cause open
The cause of the staining has not been established.

Separate surfaces
The visible subfloor and the concealed joists are different parts.

Refer the concern
Sam can arrange a qualified assessment.

Avoid a repair promise
No repair scope or price is established.

Preserve the client's question
I will include your concern about possible decay.

Use neutral wording
Dark staining observed; concealed condition unassessed.

Avoid an invented finding
There is no structural finding to report yet.

Keep the next step clear
The next step is assessment, not a guessed repair.

Read back the record
Staining beside the laundry doorway, with joists not visible and cause unknown.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State the visibility limit
Useful wording: The joists are not visible here.

Purpose: State the assessment limit
Useful wording: I have not assessed the structural condition.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which report separates observation from diagnosis?

A. The joists are rotten because the subfloor is dark.

B. The whole floor is structurally sound.

C. A leak has definitely damaged every joist.

D. Dark staining is visible on the subfloor; the concealed joists have not been assessed.

2. Which answer to Theo is unsupported?

A. The joists are not visible.

B. Structural condition has not been assessed.

C. Sam can arrange an assessment.

D. The joists are definitely sound because we cannot see damage.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Area visible after a covering is absent or removed. Which term fits?

A. qualified assessor

B. structural condition

C. exposed surface

D. investigation status

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Staining is not a structural finding". Theo: "So you can record the stain, but not my guess about what caused it as though it's a finding?" Nia: [missing response] Theo: "Could it be coming from the laundry? That was my first thought because it's so close to the doorway." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. What I can identify is dark staining on the exposed subfloor. The joists aren't visible, and I haven't assessed the structural condition.

B. I'll contact Sam to arrange a qualified assessor. The referral will give the location, what is exposed, and what we cannot currently see.

C. Exactly. I'll separate the site observation from your question: visible discoloration here, and a concern about the condition of the concealed joists.

D. Yes. This is the subfloor; the joists beneath it are concealed. A mark here doesn't tell us whether those hidden members have decay.

Answers and explanations, page 122

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The visible staining is on the exposed subfloor, not on visible joists. Theo raises possible rot as a question. The joists are concealed and structural condition has not been assessed, so neither decay nor structural soundness is established.

E Conversation

Staining is not a structural finding

Staining is not a structural finding

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

moisture source / investigation status / visibility limit / site observation / referral route / repair proposal / subfloor / laundry doorway / qualified assessor / dark staining

01 **Theo:** Nia, this dark patch by the laundry door looks worrying. Is that rot in the joists, or am I jumping to conclusions?

02 **Nia:** What I can identify is [1] _____ on the exposed subfloor. The joists aren't visible, and I haven't assessed the structural condition.

03 **Theo:** I thought what we're looking at might be the joists themselves. Are those different from this exposed layer?

04 **Nia:** Yes. This is the [2] _____; the joists beneath it are concealed. A mark here doesn't tell us whether those hidden members have decay.

05 **Theo:** So you can record the stain, but not my guess about what caused it as though it's a finding?

06 **Nia:** Exactly. I'll separate the [3] _____ from your question: visible discoloration here, and a concern about the condition of the concealed joists.

07 **Theo:** Could it be coming from the laundry? That was my first thought because it's so close to the doorway.

08 **Nia:** The [4] _____ isn't established. The location is useful to report, but it doesn't prove a leak or tell us where any water came from.

09 **Theo:** Who should look into it? I'd like someone qualified to assess it before I'm told the floor needs replacing.

10 **Nia:** I'll contact Sam to arrange a [5] _____. The referral will give the location, what is exposed, and what we cannot currently see.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Staining is not a structural finding

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Theo:** Does that mean replacement is likely? I'm trying to work out whether we need to budget for a much bigger job.

12 **Nia:** We don't have a [6] _____ yet. Asking for an assessment doesn't establish replacement, a price, or the disruption involved.

13 **Theo:** Would it be reasonable to say the joists are probably fine until someone finds damage? Or is that going too far as well?

14 **Nia:** The [7] _____ works both ways. I can't confirm decay, but hidden joists also prevent me from assuring you that the structure is sound.

15 **Theo:** All right. Please don't describe today's conversation as a structural inspection. I can imagine that getting repeated later as an all-clear.

16 **Nia:** I'll keep the [8] _____ explicit: structural condition not assessed. The visible concern is being referred, not diagnosed or signed off.

17 **Theo:** Can you read the location back? There are two laundry doors, and I don't want the person coming out to review the wrong patch.

18 **Nia:** The note identifies the exposed subfloor beside this [9] _____, with the staining shown in the referral record. It also states that the joists are concealed.

19 **Theo:** Yes, that's the area. Please give Sam the question as well as the observation, so it doesn't become just a cosmetic stain report.

20 **Nia:** I will use that [10] _____ and include your concern about possible decay. I won't add a repair conclusion or a claim of structural safety.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. dark staining / **2.** subfloor / **3.** site observation / **4.** moisture source / **5.** qualified assessor / **6.** repair proposal / **7.** visibility limit / **8.** investigation status / **9.** laundry doorway / **10.** referral route

Why these answers fit, page 123

F Check accuracy and scope

Staining is not a structural finding

Return to the case

At a laundry remodel, client Theo notices dark staining on exposed subfloor beside the laundry doorway. He asks carpenter Nia whether the joists are rotten. The joists are not visible, and Nia has not assessed structural condition. Project lead Sam can arrange a qualified assessment. Nia must describe the visible staining and the limits of her knowledge without confirming decay, declaring the structure sound, identifying a cause, or promising a repair.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which location should the referral include?

A. An invented roof leak location
B. Every wall in the house
C. A joist already exposed elsewhere
D. Beside the laundry doorway

2. What remains unknown?

A. Whether Theo asked about rot
B. Whether the joists are concealed
C. The cause, concealed structural condition, and any required repair
D. Whether staining is visible

Answers and explanations, page 125

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Retain both limits: no confirmed decay and no assurance of structural soundness.

Take the concern seriously without guessing

A worried client may hear uncertainty as evasiveness. Give a concrete observation and explain the visibility limit before naming the assessment route. Neither alarming certainty nor unsupported reassurance helps the client understand what is actually known.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Describe what is visible

Complete the report to the project lead. Keep the observed surface separate from the concealed joists and the unperformed assessment.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

assessed / visible / assessment / subfloor

01 **Carpenter:** Dark staining is visible on the exposed [1] _____.

02 **Client:** The joists are not [2] _____.

03 **Carpenter:** Structural condition has not been [3] _____.

04 **Client:** Please ask Sam to arrange a qualified [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. subfloor / **2.** visible / **3.** assessed / **4.** assessment

Why these answers fit, page 125

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Staining is not a structural finding". Theo: "Would it be reasonable to say the joists are probably fine until someone finds damage? Or is that going too far as well?" Nia: [missing response] Theo: "All right. Please don't describe today's conversation as a structural inspection. I can imagine that getting repeated later as an all-clear." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The visibility limit works both ways. I can't confirm decay, but hidden joists also prevent me from assuring you that the structure is sound.

B. I'll contact Sam to arrange a qualified assessor. The referral will give the location, what is exposed, and what we cannot currently see.

C. Yes. This is the subfloor; the joists beneath it are concealed. A mark here doesn't tell us whether those hidden members have decay.

D. The moisture source isn't established. The location is useful to report, but it doesn't prove a leak or tell us where any water came from.

Answers and explanations, page 126

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts" and "Discussing concealed conditions without guessing". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Defined visible gap or exposed setback between adjacent components. Which term fits?

A. reveal
B. review deadline
C. fabrication
D. superseded drawing

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Deterioration of wood through biological action. Which term fits?

A. inspection access
B. timber decay
C. subfloor
D. structural finding

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Two oak samples, different trade-offs". Oliver: "That makes B six days quicker on the quote. I still prefer A's grain, so I'm not ready to choose on timing alone." Mei: [missing response] Oliver: "And I wouldn't lose this edge shape by choosing B? The study trim needs the profile we've already discussed." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. We do not have a price comparison. I also cannot support a performance claim about which lasts longer from the information on these two samples.
B. A has pronounced grain, and B has a more uniform appearance. Those are the visual differences stated for these samples, not a ranking of quality.
C. I will keep the selection status open. We can note your interest in A without recording it as an approved sample or a placed order.
D. Exactly. Your visual preference and the timing are separate considerations. We can compare them without deciding that one sample is better in every respect.

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Staining is not a structural finding". Theo: "Can you read the location back? There are two laundry doors, and I don't want the person coming out to review the wrong patch." Nia: [missing response] Theo: "Yes, that's the area. Please give Sam the question as well as the observation, so it doesn't become just a cosmetic stain report." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will use that referral route and include your concern about possible decay. I won't add a repair conclusion or a claim of structural safety.

B. The moisture source isn't established. The location is useful to report, but it doesn't prove a leak or tell us where any water came from.

C. The visibility limit works both ways. I can't confirm decay, but hidden joists also prevent me from assuring you that the structure is sound.

D. The note identifies the exposed subfloor beside this laundry doorway, with the staining shown in the referral record. It also states that the joists are concealed.

Answers and explanations, page 149

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / SEPARATING REQUESTED EXTRAS FROM AGREED WORK

Explain the agreed task, clarify an additional request, and discuss a separate quotation without implying approval or completion timing.

A bench beyond the skirting scope

At a bedroom remodel, carpenter Jules reviews the scope with client Amara. The agreed work is replacing skirting only. Decorating is excluded. Amara asks for a built-in bench as an extra. Jules can arrange a separate quotation, but no bench dimensions, price, or completion date are agreed. The conversation must distinguish the existing trim work from the requested bench and must not imply that decorating or a free extra is included.

People: Amara, Client; Jules, Carpenter.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is included in the current scope?

A. A built-in bench and full decorating
B. All bedroom furniture
C. A confirmed bench installation
D. Replacing bedroom skirting only

2. What is the new request?

A. A built-in bench
B. The skirting replacement already agreed
C. A completed painting inspection
D. A warranty extension

3. What can Jules arrange?

A. A separate quotation, with dimensions, price, and date still unagreed
B. A free bench completed tomorrow
C. Automatic decorating
D. A confirmed bench design already approved

Answers and explanations, page 127

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

skirting
Trim along the base of an internal wall, often called baseboard.

replace the skirting

baseboard
Common North American term for trim at the foot of an internal wall.

compare baseboard profiles

built-in bench
Fixed seating integrated into a room or fitted assembly.

request a built-in bench

agreed scope
Work explicitly included in the current agreement.

confirm the agreed scope

scope exclusion
Work or condition left outside the agreement.

explain the scope exclusion

decorating
Surface finishing work such as painting or wallpapering.

distinguish decorating from carpentry

additional work
Task requested beyond the existing scope.

quote for additional work

separate quotation
Distinct price proposal for specified extra work.

arrange a separate quotation

bench dimensions
Measurements defining the proposed bench.

agree the bench dimensions

design brief
Statement of the requirements for a proposed design.

clarify the design brief

seat height
Vertical position of a seat surface from a stated reference.

confirm the seat height

seat depth
Front-to-back dimension of a seat surface.

clarify the seat depth

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

skirting SKIRTING

replace the skirting

Keep the meaning precise: Trim along the base of an internal wall, often called baseboard.

decorating DECORATING

distinguish decorating from carpentry

Keep the meaning precise: Surface finishing work such as painting or wallpapering.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

overall length
Full end-to-end measurement of an item.
confirm the overall length

quotation scope
Tasks and terms covered by a price proposal.
define the quotation scope

change authorization
Permission to alter the agreed work.
obtain change authorization

completion commitment
Agreed promise about when work will finish.
avoid an unsupported completion commitment

measurement visit
Attendance to establish relevant dimensions.
discuss a measurement visit

existing contract
Current agreement governing the booked work.
distinguish the existing contract

finish requirement
Specified surface appearance or treatment.
clarify the finish requirement

variation
Agreed or proposed change to the original work arrangement.
record a proposed variation

price agreement
Acceptance of a stated cost for defined work.
confirm the price agreement

book matching
Pairing consecutive veneer leaves by alternating their faces for mirrored grain.
specify book matching

client approval
Acceptance from the client through the relevant process.
record client approval

scope handoff
Transfer of the task description for further review or quotation.
make a clear scope handoff

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

seat depth SEAT DEPTH
clarify the seat depth
Keep the meaning precise: Front-to-back dimension of a seat surface.

change authorization CHANGE AUTHORIZATION
obtain change authorization
Keep the meaning precise: Permission to alter the agreed work.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the idea

I understand you would like a built-in bench as well.

State the exclusion

Decorating is excluded from this booking.

Offer the next step

I can arrange a separate quotation.

Keep price open

There is no agreed bench price yet.

Avoid a free-extra promise

I cannot treat the bench as a free addition.

Clarify the proposal

We need a defined bench request for the quotation.

Preserve existing work

The skirting replacement remains the agreed task.

Read back the request

Built-in bench requested; dimensions, price, and timing unresolved.

Name the agreement

The current scope is replacing the bedroom skirting only.

Separate the extra

The bench is additional work, not part of the existing task.

Keep dimensions open

We have not agreed the bench dimensions.

Keep timing open

No completion date is confirmed for the bench.

Avoid bundling decorating

A bench request does not add painting to the current scope.

Separate asking and approving

Asking for a quote does not approve the extra work.

Avoid designing by assumption

I will not put guessed measurements into the handoff.

Close with the route

I will pass the bench request for a separate quotation.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Separate the extra
Useful wording: The bench is additional work, not part of the existing task.

Purpose: Offer the next step
Useful wording: I can arrange a separate quotation.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which scope summary is accurate?

A. The skirting task has been cancelled.
B. Skirting replacement only; decorating excluded; bench requested separately.
C. Bench and decorating already included.
D. All bedroom work is free because the crew is present.

2. Which response is helpful without overpromising?

A. I can arrange a separate quotation, with dimensions and timing still to be agreed.
B. I guarantee a bench tomorrow at no charge.
C. The question itself changes the contract.
D. I will invent dimensions to speed things up.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Work explicitly included in the current agreement. Which term fits?

A. agreed scope
B. measurement visit
C. quotation scope
D. bench dimensions

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A bench beyond the skirting scope". Amara: "Could I get a separate price before I decide? I'm asking for an option, not telling you to start building it." Jules: [missing response] Amara: "I haven't settled the length or depth. When I pointed at the wall, I didn't mean that the bench must fill the whole space." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I can pass on the idea, but the agreed scope is skirting replacement only. A built-in bench would be a separate item rather than part of the existing task.

B. I can arrange a separate quotation. Asking for that quote does not mean you have approved the bench or agreed to pay an amount we have not supplied.

C. The current scope exclusion remains decorating. The bench request does not add painting to today's agreement, and any proposed finish would need to be stated in its own quotation.

D. It is additional work, and we need a defined proposal for it. Being on site does not establish the dimensions, the price, or when it could be completed.

Answers and explanations, page 127

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Replacing the bedroom skirting is the only agreed task. The bench is an additional request, and decorating is excluded. A separate quotation can be arranged, but the request itself does not establish bench measurements, an accepted price, or a completion date.

E Conversation

A bench beyond the skirting scope

A bench beyond the skirting scope

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

agreed scope / scope exclusion / Change authorization / separate quotation / bench dimensions / additional work / quotation scope / completion commitment / scope handoff / existing contract

01 **Amara:** While you're doing the bedroom skirting, could you also build a bench along that wall? I'm wondering whether it could be added to this visit.

02 **Jules:** I can pass on the idea, but the [1] _____ is skirting replacement only. A built-in bench would be a separate item rather than part of the existing task.

03 **Amara:** I realize it isn't another piece of skirting. I thought being here already might make it simpler, but I haven't worked out the details.

04 **Jules:** It is [2] _____, and we need a defined proposal for it. Being on site does not establish the dimensions, the price, or when it could be completed.

05 **Amara:** Could I get a separate price before I decide? I'm asking for an option, not telling you to start building it.

06 **Jules:** I can arrange a [3] _____. Asking for that quote does not mean you have approved the bench or agreed to pay an amount we have not supplied.

07 **Amara:** I haven't settled the length or depth. When I pointed at the wall, I didn't mean that the bench must fill the whole space.

08 **Jules:** I will keep the [4] _____ unresolved. The handoff will describe a built-in bench request without turning your gesture into a fixed length or depth.

09 **Amara:** What about painting? I know decorating isn't in the present booking. Would a bench quote need to say explicitly whether finishing is included?

10 **Jules:** The current [5] _____ remains decorating. The bench request does not add painting to today's agreement, and any proposed finish would need to be stated in its own quotation.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A bench beyond the skirting scope

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Amara:** Yes, I'd rather see what's covered than compare prices that mean different things. The finish could affect which proposal I accept.

12 **Jules:** A clear [6] _____ matters. We should not promise a finish, a design, or a service that has not been defined in the proposal.

13 **Amara:** Could it be finished this week? I'm asking whether that's possible, but I don't want you to put a date into the quote without checking.

14 **Jules:** No [7] _____ has been made for the bench. I cannot give you a confirmed date before the proposed work and arrangements are agreed.

15 **Amara:** Then today's skirting job stays as agreed while the bench is priced separately. Is there anything in this discussion that changes the existing booking?

16 **Jules:** I will preserve the [8] _____ scope. The skirting remains the agreed task, and the bench will be recorded as a separate request for pricing.

17 **Amara:** Good. Please don't take my interest as approval. I'll review the defined proposal and price before giving a decision on the extra work.

18 **Jules:** Correct. [9] _____ has not happened in this conversation. I will not describe your interest as approval to start building or to choose measurements for you.

19 **Amara:** Please pass on: built-in bedroom bench requested for a separate quote; size, finish, price, and timing unresolved. No instruction to proceed.

20 **Jules:** I will make that [10] _____ clearly. The note will keep the bench proposal separate, preserve the decorating exclusion, and leave the unagreed details open for the quotation process.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. agreed scope / **2.** additional work / **3.** separate quotation / **4.** bench dimensions / **5.** scope exclusion / **6.** quotation scope / **7.** completion commitment / **8.** existing contract / **9.** Change authorization / **10.** scope handoff

Why these answers fit, page 128

F Check accuracy and scope

A bench beyond the skirting scope

Return to the case

At a bedroom remodel, carpenter Jules reviews the scope with client Amara. The agreed work is replacing skirting only. Decorating is excluded. Amara asks for a built-in bench as an extra. Jules can arrange a separate quotation, but no bench dimensions, price, or completion date are agreed. The conversation must distinguish the existing trim work from the requested bench and must not imply that decorating or a free extra is included.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What does requesting a quote establish?

A. A final price agreement
B. A confirmed completion date
C. Approval of any design
D. Interest in having the extra work priced, not approval to perform it

2. Which item must remain excluded from the current booking?

A. Decorating
B. Skirting replacement
C. Recording the bench request
D. Clarifying the existing task

Answers and explanations, page 130

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress quotation, authorization, and unresolved timing.

A helpful referral can preserve a firm scope limit

An additional request often arises when a client sees the room taking shape. Acknowledge the idea, identify the existing agreement, and offer the actual quotation route. Avoid making the client feel dismissed while also avoiding a casual promise that creates a different expectation.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Keep an extra request separate

Complete the client exchange about the bedroom work. Preserve the original task, excluded decorating, separate quotation, and unresolved bench dimensions.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

skirting / quotation / excluded / agreed

01 **Carpenter:** The agreed task is replacing the [1] _____.

02 **Client:** Decorating remains [2] _____.

03 **Carpenter:** I can arrange a separate [3] _____ for the bench.

04 **Client:** The bench dimensions are not yet [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. skirting / **2.** excluded / **3.** quotation / **4.** agreed

Why these answers fit, page 130

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A bench beyond the skirting scope". Amara: "Could it be finished this week? I'm asking whether that's possible, but I don't want you to put a date into the quote without checking." Jules: [missing response] Amara: "Then today's skirting job stays as agreed while the bench is priced separately. Is there anything in this discussion that changes the existing booking?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will preserve the existing contract scope. The skirting remains the agreed task, and the bench will be recorded as a separate request for pricing.

B. A clear quotation scope matters. We should not promise a finish, a design, or a service that has not been defined in the proposal.

C. I will keep the bench dimensions unresolved. The handoff will describe a built-in bench request without turning your gesture into a fixed length or depth.

D. No completion commitment has been made for the bench. I cannot give you a confirmed date before the proposed work and arrangements are agreed.

Answers and explanations, page 131

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / COORDINATING ACCESS AND OTHER TRADES

Report delivery, room access, review timing, and storage restrictions as separate arrangements when coordinating with other trades.

> **Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved**
>
> Carpenter Ben updates site coordinator Farah on the study joinery. Delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning, but the decorator has not released the study for carpentry access. The hallway is available for a separate trim review at 11:00, not for material storage. Farah needs a precise status report. Ben must not turn the delivery confirmation into installation access, or the hallway review arrangement into permission to leave delivered joinery there.

People: Farah, Site coordinator; Ben, Carpenter.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What is confirmed?

A. Joinery delivery for Tuesday morning
B. Study access for installation
C. Hallway material storage
D. Completion of decorating

2. What remains unresolved?

A. Whether the hallway review is at 11:00
B. Whether delivery is Tuesday morning
C. Whether hallway storage is permitted
D. The decorator has not released the study for carpentry access

3. What is the hallway available for?

A. Unrestricted use by every trade
B. A separate trim review at 11:00, not storage
C. All delivered material storage
D. Automatic study installation

Answers and explanations, page 132

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

joinery
Fitted woodwork or related manufactured components for a project.

coordinate the joinery delivery

trade coordination
Arrangement of work between different specialist teams.

improve trade coordination

decorator
Trade worker responsible for agreed surface finishing work.

coordinate with the decorator

work area
Location assigned for a particular task.

identify the work area

storage permission
Authorization to leave materials in a defined location.

confirm storage permission

site coordinator
Person coordinating site arrangements across people or tasks.

update the site coordinator

delivery slot
Agreed time period for receiving goods.

confirm the delivery slot

access release
Confirmation that a defined area is available for the specified work.

request an access release

carpentry access
Permission and readiness to enter an area for carpentry work.

confirm carpentry access

trim review
Check or discussion of the specified trim details.

attend the trim review

material staging
Temporary positioning of materials before use or movement.

distinguish material staging from a review

dependency
Condition that another action relies on.

identify the access dependency

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

joinery JOINERY

coordinate the joinery delivery

Keep the meaning precise: Fitted woodwork or related manufactured components for a project.

carpentry access CARPENTRY ACCESS

confirm carpentry access

Keep the meaning precise: Permission and readiness to enter an area for carpentry work.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

area readiness

Whether a location is prepared for the intended activity.

confirm area readiness

installation access

Availability of an area for fitting work.

verify installation access

moisture content

Water mass expressed here as a percentage of oven-dry wood mass.

report wood moisture content

equilibrium moisture content

Wood moisture at balance with surrounding temperature and humidity.

distinguish equilibrium moisture content

storage location

Place where materials may be held.

confirm the storage location

status readback

Repetition of key arrangements to check understanding.

provide a status readback

handover between trades

Transfer of an area or task from one trade to another.

coordinate the handover between trades

confirmed delivery

Agreed arrival arrangement for goods.

report the confirmed delivery

purpose-specific access

Permission limited to a named activity.

respect purpose-specific access

logistics update

Report on movement, receipt, access, or related arrangements.

give a logistics update

schedule dependency

Arrangement that must be resolved for a later task to proceed.

report a schedule dependency

coordination query

Question seeking clarification of interdependent arrangements.

raise a coordination query

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

dependency DEPENDENCY

identify the access dependency

Keep the meaning precise: Condition that another action relies on.

moisture content MOISTURE CONTENT

report wood moisture content

Keep the meaning precise: Water mass expressed here as a percentage of oven-dry wood mass.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Start with delivery

The joinery delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning.

Name the dependency

We still need the decorator's access release.

State the review arrangement

The hallway is available for the trim review at 11:00.

Clarify the purpose

That access is for a review, not for staging the delivery.

Avoid changing the booking

I have not changed the delivery slot.

Preserve trade coordination

Please keep the access question visible in the coordination update.

Read back the arrangements

Tuesday delivery, study unreleased, 11:00 hallway review, no hallway storage.

Keep installation separate

No installation start is established by this update.

Separate the room status

The study has not been released for carpentry access.

Avoid merging permissions

Delivery confirmation does not establish installation access.

State the restriction

The hallway is not available for material storage.

Keep an alternative open

No alternative storage location is confirmed here.

Avoid guessing readiness

I do not have a confirmed study-release time.

Avoid assigning blame

I am reporting the release status, not a cause of delay.

Ask for clarification

Can you coordinate the unresolved access arrangement?

Close with the open item

Study access remains the unresolved dependency.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Avoid merging permissions
Useful wording: Delivery confirmation does not establish installation access.

Purpose: State the review arrangement
Useful wording: The hallway is available for the trim review at 11:00.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which status report is accurate?

A. Hallway storage approved until decorating finishes.

B. Study installation guaranteed at 11:00.

C. Tuesday-morning delivery confirmed; study access unreleased; hallway review at 11:00; no hallway storage.

D. All rooms ready because delivery is confirmed.

2. Which inference is unsupported?

A. Study release remains unresolved.

B. A confirmed delivery means the study is ready for installation.

C. The hallway review has a stated time.

D. Storage in the hallway is excluded.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Confirmation that a defined area is available for the specified work. Which term fits?

A. storage permission

B. storage location

C. installation access

D. access release

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved". Farah: "Then what exactly is booked for eleven in the hallway? The word access in the message is a bit too broad for me." Ben: [missing response] Farah: "Can the joinery wait in the hallway until the study is released? I'm asking before anyone puts that location on the delivery instructions." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. The schedule dependency is still the study release. No alternative storage, changed delivery slot, or installation start has been established in this update.

B. The hallway is available for a trim review at 11:00. That is a separate activity, and the hallway is not available for material storage.

C. No confirmed access release time is available. I want that dependency kept visible rather than treated as settled in the delivery update.

D. No alternative storage location is confirmed here. I should not invent one or assume that a room available for a discussion can receive the delivery.

Answers and explanations, page 132

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Tuesday morning belongs to the confirmed delivery. Study access is not released. The 11:00 hallway arrangement is for a trim review only, and hallway storage is not permitted. These are separate facts, not a single approval for delivery, storage, and installation.

E Conversation

Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved

Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

trim review / Purpose-specific access / storage location / logistics update / schedule dependency / status readback / confirmed delivery / access release / Installation access / delivery slot

01 **Farah:** Ben, I have Tuesday delivery in the diary and an eleven-o'clock review. Does that mean the study will be ready to install, or am I combining separate arrangements?

02 **Ben:** The [1] _____ is confirmed for Tuesday morning. The study, however, has not been released by the decorator for carpentry access.

03 **Farah:** Is the decorator finished with the study? I don't want the delivery confirmation to be read as permission for the installers to enter that room.

04 **Ben:** No confirmed [2] _____ time is available. I want that dependency kept visible rather than treated as settled in the delivery update.

05 **Farah:** Then what exactly is booked for eleven in the hallway? The word access in the message is a bit too broad for me.

06 **Ben:** The hallway is available for a [3] _____ at 11:00. That is a separate activity, and the hallway is not available for material storage.

07 **Farah:** Can the joinery wait in the hallway until the study is released? I'm asking before anyone puts that location on the delivery instructions.

08 **Ben:** No alternative [4] _____ is confirmed here. I should not invent one or assume that a room available for a discussion can receive the delivery.

09 **Farah:** So the delivery is still Tuesday morning, even though we don't yet have a permitted storage arrangement? Please don't invent a new slot in the update.

10 **Ben:** I have not changed the [5] _____. Tuesday morning is still the stated slot. The update flags the mismatch without claiming that a replacement plan exists.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Farah:** And we can't advertise Tuesday installation just because the material is arriving? The room release is still the missing part.

12 **Ben:** No. [6] _____ remains unresolved. Delivery, room release, and the start of fitting work should not be compressed into one promise.

13 **Farah:** Please put that distinction in the coordination message. What would you say without blaming the decorator for a delay we haven't established?

14 **Ben:** That is the right [7] _____ to give. I am reporting the current release status, not a reason for it or a claim that another trade has missed a deadline.

15 **Farah:** Read the four statuses back separately, please. I want delivery, study access, review access, and storage to be unmistakable.

16 **Ben:** Here is the [8] _____: Tuesday-morning delivery confirmed; study unreleased; hallway trim review at 11:00; no material storage in the hallway.

17 **Farah:** Do we know when the study will be released? If not, keep that unknown rather than using eleven o'clock as a convenient estimate.

18 **Ben:** Yes. The [9] _____ is still the study release. No alternative storage, changed delivery slot, or installation start has been established in this update.

19 **Farah:** All right. Please flag the unresolved coordination to me. The hallway review permission mustn't turn into a general storage or installation permission.

20 **Ben:** Exactly. [10] _____ is the key point for the hallway. I will keep the review permission and the storage restriction together whenever I pass the update on.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. delivery slot / **2.** access release / **3.** trim review / **4.** storage location / **5.** confirmed delivery / **6.** Installation access / **7.** logistics update / **8.** status readback / **9.** schedule dependency / **10.** Purpose-specific access

Why these answers fit, page 133

F Check accuracy and scope

Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved

Return to the case

Carpenter Ben updates site coordinator Farah on the study joinery. Delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning, but the decorator has not released the study for carpentry access. The hallway is available for a separate trim review at 11:00, not for material storage. Farah needs a precise status report. Ben must not turn the delivery confirmation into installation access, or the hallway review arrangement into permission to leave delivered joinery there.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What can Farah coordinate next?

A. The unresolved study-access arrangement
B. A completed installation already claimed
C. A storage location assumed without approval
D. A new delivery time invented by Ben

2. Which hallway statement should be corrected?

A. The hallway is available for the specified review.
B. Storage permission is absent.
C. We can store the joinery there because the trim review is allowed.
D. The review is at 11:00.

Answers and explanations, page 135

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20. Read the four statuses without adding a storage location or installation time.

Coordinate by purpose, not just by place and time

A room can be available for one activity and unavailable for another. State the purpose attached to each arrangement. Trade coordination works best when delivery, access, review, and storage are reported separately, with the unresolved dependency visible.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Keep four arrangements separate

Complete the coordinator update. Preserve the confirmed delivery, unreleased study, hallway review time, and storage restriction.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

Tuesday / 11:00 / storage / released

01 **Carpenter:** Delivery is confirmed for [1] _____ morning.

02 **Coordinator:** The study has not been [2] _____ for carpentry access.

03 **Carpenter:** The hallway trim review is at [3] _____.

04 **Coordinator:** The hallway is not available for material [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. Tuesday / **2.** released / **3.** 11:00 / **4.** storage

Why these answers fit, page 135

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved". Farah: "Please put that distinction in the coordination message. What would you say without blaming the decorator for a delay we haven't established?" Ben: [missing response] Farah: "Read the four statuses back separately, please. I want delivery, study access, review access, and storage to be unmistakable." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Purpose-specific access is the key point for the hallway. I will keep the review permission and the storage restriction together whenever I pass the update on.

B. I have not changed the confirmed delivery. Tuesday morning is still the stated slot. The update flags the mismatch without claiming that a replacement plan exists.

C. No alternative storage location is confirmed here. I should not invent one or assume that a room available for a discussion can receive the delivery.

D. That is the right logistics update to give. I am reporting the current release status, not a reason for it or a claim that another trade has missed a deadline.

Answers and explanations, page 136

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Separating requested extras from agreed work" and "Coordinating access and other trades". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Fixed seating integrated into a room or fitted assembly. Which term fits?

A. separate quotation
B. built-in bench
C. finish requirement
D. book matching

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Check or discussion of the specified trim details. Which term fits?

A. area readiness
B. trim review
C. equilibrium moisture content
D. joinery

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Staining is not a structural finding". Theo: "Who should look into it? I'd like someone qualified to assess it before I'm told the floor needs replacing." Nia: [missing response] Theo: "Does that mean replacement is likely? I'm trying to work out whether we need to budget for a much bigger job." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. I'll separate the site observation from your question: visible discoloration here, and a concern about the condition of the concealed joists.
B. I'll contact Sam to arrange a qualified assessor. The referral will give the location, what is exposed, and what we cannot currently see.
C. What I can identify is dark staining on the exposed subfloor. The joists aren't visible, and I haven't assessed the structural condition.
D. Yes. This is the subfloor; the joists beneath it are concealed. A mark here doesn't tell us whether those hidden members have decay.

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved". Farah: "Do we know when the study will be released? If not, keep that unknown rather than using eleven o'clock as a convenient estimate." Ben: [missing response] Farah: "All right. Please flag the unresolved coordination to me. The hallway review permission mustn't turn into a general storage or installation permission." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No confirmed access release time is available. I want that dependency kept visible rather than treated as settled in the delivery update.

B. Yes. The schedule dependency is still the study release. No alternative storage, changed delivery slot, or installation start has been established in this update.

C. The hallway is available for a trim review at 11:00. That is a separate activity, and the hallway is not available for material storage.

D. No alternative storage location is confirmed here. I should not invent one or assume that a room available for a discussion can receive the delivery.

Answers and explanations, page 151

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / REVIEWING FIT, APPEARANCE, AND SNAGGING

Withdraw an inaccurate overall claim, describe a specific alignment observation, and record follow-up without guessing the remedy.

> **Correcting the claim about drawer D3**
>
> During a wardrobe review, carpenter Luis tells client Priya that all fronts are flush. Priya points out drawer D3: its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. Luis has not assessed the cause or remedy. He must correct his earlier statement and add the specific observation for follow-up. The conversation does not establish a measured offset, a tolerance failure, a damaged runner, or an agreed repair and completion time.

People: Priya, Client; Luis, Carpenter.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which earlier statement must Luis correct?

A. D3 needs follow-up
B. The cause is unassessed
C. No repair time is agreed
D. All fronts are flush

2. What does Priya identify?

A. Every drawer is broken
B. A confirmed damaged runner
C. A measured five-millimeter offset
D. D3's left edge projects beyond the neighboring front

3. What should Luis do next in the conversation?

A. Correct the claim and record the specific observation for follow-up
B. Deny the visible exception
C. Promise a replacement runner immediately
D. Declare the projection acceptable without assessment

Answers and explanations, page 137

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

flush
Aligned in the same plane at the relevant surfaces.

check whether the fronts are flush

drawer front
Visible face panel of a drawer.

identify the drawer front

neighboring front
Adjacent visible face used as a comparison.

compare the neighboring front

projecting edge
Edge extending beyond a stated reference surface.

describe the projecting edge

left edge
Left-hand boundary of the identified component.

locate the left edge

alignment
Relative positioning of components or surfaces.

review the alignment

offset
Displacement between specified reference positions or surfaces.

measure the offset

tolerance
Permitted variation under an applicable specification.

check the applicable tolerance

snag
Item requiring attention during a completion or quality review.

record a snag

snagging list
Record of items requiring follow-up before agreed closure.

add to the snagging list

punch list
Common North American term for a list of completion or correction items.

update the punch list

fit review
Examination of how components align or work together.

conduct a fit review

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

flush FLUSH

check whether the fronts are flush

Keep the meaning precise: Aligned in the same plane at the relevant surfaces.

alignment ALIGNMENT

review the alignment

Keep the meaning precise: Relative positioning of components or surfaces.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

appearance review
Examination of visible finish and presentation.
record an appearance review

drawer runner
Mechanism or support guiding a drawer's movement.
inspect the drawer runner

hinge
Joint allowing a door or panel to pivot.
identify the hinge

adjustment
Change to a component's setting or position.
assess the need for adjustment

remedy
Action intended to correct an established problem.
assess the appropriate remedy

root cause
Underlying reason for an observed problem.
investigate the root cause

correction of record
Amendment of an inaccurate earlier statement.
make a correction of record

specific exception
Identified case that contradicts a general claim.
acknowledge the specific exception

quality claim
Statement about the condition or standard of work.
qualify the quality claim

follow-up item
Matter retained for further checking or action.
record a follow-up item

slip matching
Placing consecutive veneer leaves alongside each other in the same face orientation.
compare slip matching

closeout status
Whether review and required follow-up are complete.
preserve the closeout status

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

fit review FIT REVIEW

conduct a fit review

Keep the meaning precise: Examination of how components align or work together.

remedy REMEDY

assess the appropriate remedy

Keep the meaning precise: Action intended to correct an established problem.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Correct the earlier statement

I need to correct what I said about all the fronts being flush.

Acknowledge the exception

You are right to point out D3.

Name the component

The observation concerns drawer D3.

Locate the edge

Its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front.

Avoid a guessed measurement

I have not established the amount of the offset.

Avoid a tolerance claim

I have not checked the applicable tolerance.

Keep the cause open

The cause has not been assessed.

Keep the remedy open

I have not determined the appropriate remedy.

Avoid blaming hardware

I cannot call the runner defective from this observation alone.

Record the follow-up

I will add the specific item to the snagging list.

Preserve the comparison

The neighboring front is the reference in this observation.

Avoid minimizing

I will not dismiss it as acceptable without checking.

Avoid a repair promise

No repair method or completion time is agreed.

Limit the finding

This identifies D3, not every drawer in the wardrobe.

Read back the item

D3 left edge projects; cause and remedy unassessed.

Close honestly

The earlier overall claim is corrected and this item remains open.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Locate the edge
Useful wording: Its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front.

Purpose: Avoid a guessed measurement
Useful wording: I have not established the amount of the offset.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which opening corrects the earlier claim?

A. D3 is an exception, but the overall flush claim can stay unchanged.

B. D3 projects, so its runner needs replacement.

C. D3 looks close enough to accept without checking tolerance.

D. I need to correct that: D3's left edge is not flush with the neighboring front.

2. Which snag entry is precise?

A. All drawers broken and replacement approved.

B. Wardrobe fine; no follow-up.

C. Five-millimeter failure repaired.

D. D3 left edge projects beyond neighboring front; cause and remedy unassessed.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Edge extending beyond a stated reference surface. Which term fits?

A. hinge

B. quality claim

C. projecting edge

D. snag

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Correcting the claim about drawer D3". Priya: "Is it a runner fault? I wondered whether adjusting the hardware would bring it back, but I don't know what's behind it." Luis: [missing response] Priya: "How far does it project? I can see the edge, but I haven't measured it, and I don't want my estimate repeated as a measurement." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The root cause hasn't been assessed. I can't call the runner defective or promise that a particular adjustment will correct the position.

B. I'll identify the drawer front as D3 and specify its left edge relative to the neighboring front. That is the visible difference.

C. The offset isn't established numerically. I'll record the observation without inventing a millimeter figure or treating an estimate as a checked dimension.

D. The remedy hasn't been determined, and no completion time is agreed. I'll avoid turning a possible adjustment into an approved repair promise.

Answers and explanations, page 137

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Luis must withdraw all fronts are flush because D3 provides a specific exception. The observation is a projecting left edge relative to the neighboring front. It does not establish the projection amount, applicable tolerance, underlying cause, or correct remedy.

E Conversation

Correcting the claim about drawer D3

Correcting the claim about drawer D3

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

snagging list / quality claim / offset / tolerance / closeout status / root cause / follow-up item / remedy / correction of record / drawer front

01 **Priya:** Luis, you said all the fronts were flush. D3's left edge is sitting forward of the neighboring front. Can you check what you told me?

02 **Luis:** You're right; I need a [1] _____. All fronts are flush was too broad. D3 is an exception, and I withdraw that overall statement.

03 **Priya:** Thank you. I don't want the list to say wardrobe problem, though. Someone coming back needs to know which edge we're discussing.

04 **Luis:** I'll identify the [2] _____ as D3 and specify its left edge relative to the neighboring front. That is the visible difference.

05 **Priya:** Is it a runner fault? I wondered whether adjusting the hardware would bring it back, but I don't know what's behind it.

06 **Luis:** The [3] _____ hasn't been assessed. I can't call the runner defective or promise that a particular adjustment will correct the position.

07 **Priya:** How far does it project? I can see the edge, but I haven't measured it, and I don't want my estimate repeated as a measurement.

08 **Luis:** The [4] _____ isn't established numerically. I'll record the observation without inventing a millimeter figure or treating an estimate as a checked dimension.

09 **Priya:** So we can't call it within tolerance yet? Earlier I thought you were saying the whole installation had passed that comparison.

10 **Luis:** I haven't checked the applicable [5] _____ for this item. I won't dismiss it as acceptable, or make the opposite specification finding, without that check.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Correcting the claim about drawer D3

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Priya:** Please make sure it stays on the follow-up list. I don't want a general handover tick to hide this particular point.

12 **Luis:** I'll add it to the [6] _____: D3, left edge projects beyond the neighboring front, with cause and appropriate action still to be assessed.

13 **Priya:** Does correcting your earlier statement mean you're saying every drawer is wrong now? That's not what I'm asking you to report.

14 **Luis:** No. The [7] _____ is narrowed by this specific exception. We have identified D3; we haven't established that all the other fronts have the same issue.

15 **Priya:** Can you tell me what will be done and when, or do those both have to wait for the follow-up assessment?

16 **Luis:** The [8] _____ hasn't been determined, and no completion time is agreed. I'll avoid turning a possible adjustment into an approved repair promise.

17 **Priya:** Then read me the item as it will appear. I'd like the edge and comparison surface to survive the handoff.

18 **Luis:** The [9] _____ says D3's left edge projects beyond the neighboring front; amount, cause, tolerance comparison, and appropriate action are not established.

19 **Priya:** That's accurate. Please keep it open after today's discussion. Correcting the wording doesn't itself put the front into the right position.

20 **Luis:** Agreed. The [10] _____ stays open. I've corrected what I said, but the physical item and its follow-up still need to be resolved.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. correction of record / **2.** drawer front / **3.** root cause / **4.** offset / **5.** tolerance / **6.** snagging list / **7.** quality claim / **8.** remedy / **9.** follow-up item / **10.** closeout status

Why these answers fit, page 138

F Check accuracy and scope

Correcting the claim about drawer D3

Return to the case

During a wardrobe review, carpenter Luis tells client Priya that all fronts are flush. Priya points out drawer D3: its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front. Luis has not assessed the cause or remedy. He must correct his earlier statement and add the specific observation for follow-up. The conversation does not establish a measured offset, a tolerance failure, a damaged runner, or an agreed repair and completion time.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which conclusion is unsupported?

A. D3 needs follow-up.
B. The left edge projects.
C. The earlier all-fronts claim needs correction.
D. A replacement runner is definitely required.

2. What remains open after recording the item?

A. Whether Luis made the earlier claim
B. Whether Priya identified D3
C. Which edge is described
D. Cause, remedy, and any completion arrangement

Answers and explanations, page 140

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20; distinguish the observed projection from a tolerance decision or repair promise.

A direct correction protects trust

When a client identifies an exception to an overall claim, acknowledge it explicitly. Correct the claim and record the observable detail. Avoid defending the original wording, minimizing the concern without a standard, or promising a repair before the cause has been assessed.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Correct and record the exception

Complete the review exchange. Correct the universal claim, identify the projecting edge, and leave the cause and remedy unresolved.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

unassessed / left / flush / D3

01 **Carpenter:** I need to correct my claim that all fronts are [1] _____.

02 **Client:** The specific drawer is [2] _____.

03 **Carpenter:** Its [3] _____ edge projects beyond the neighboring front.

04 **Client:** The cause and remedy remain [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. flush / **2.** D3 / **3.** left / **4.** unassessed

Why these answers fit, page 140

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Correcting the claim about drawer D3". Priya: "Does correcting your earlier statement mean you're saying every drawer is wrong now? That's not what I'm asking you to report." Luis: [missing response] Priya: "Can you tell me what will be done and when, or do those both have to wait for the follow-up assessment?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I haven't checked the applicable tolerance for this item. I won't dismiss it as acceptable, or make the opposite specification finding, without that check.

B. No. The quality claim is narrowed by this specific exception. We have identified D3; we haven't established that all the other fronts have the same issue.

C. You're right; I need a correction of record. All fronts are flush was too broad. D3 is an exception, and I withdraw that overall statement.

D. I'll add it to the snagging list: D3, left edge projects beyond the neighboring front, with cause and appropriate action still to be assessed.

Answers and explanations, page 141

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / HANDING OVER RECORDS AND RETURN VISITS

Confirm supplied documents, record an undelivered part, and distinguish an accepted callback commitment from an unconfirmed return visit.

> **Documents received, one cover outstanding**
>
> At a cabinet handover, owner Daniel receives the cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet from joinery lead Mina. A replacement shelf pin cover is due but has not arrived. Mina accepts responsibility for supplier follow-up and commits to calling Daniel on Friday. No return-visit date is confirmed. Warranty terms remain those in the supplied document; Mina must not invent wider coverage or imply that receiving the documents means every outstanding item is complete.

People: Daniel, Owner; Mina, Joinery lead.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which documents does Daniel receive?

A. A new verbal warranty replacing the document
B. A completed supplier investigation
C. Cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet
D. Only an unrelated product leaflet

2. What remains outstanding?

A. The correct care sheet
B. A confirmed Friday installation
C. A replacement shelf pin cover that is due but not delivered
D. All cabinet drawings

3. What does Mina commit to?

A. A guaranteed supplier arrival time
B. Supplier follow-up and a Friday call, with no confirmed return visit
C. A Friday return visit and unlimited warranty
D. A delivered cover already fitted

Answers and explanations, page 142

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

handover pack
Collection of documents supplied at a project handover.

confirm the handover pack

care sheet
Instructions for looking after a specified finish or product.

supply the correct care sheet

shelf pin
Small support component used to locate or carry a shelf.

identify the shelf pin

replacement part
Component supplied to replace a specified item.

track the replacement part

due delivery
Expected arrival that has not necessarily occurred.

distinguish due delivery from receipt

action owner
Person responsible for carrying out a defined next step.

name the action owner

cabinet drawing
Drawing showing the relevant cabinet arrangement or details.

provide the cabinet drawings

finish identification
Confirmation of the surface treatment a document applies to.

check finish identification

pin cover
Cover associated with the specified pin or fitting.

identify the replacement pin cover

outstanding item
Matter not yet completed, delivered, or resolved.

retain an outstanding item

supplier follow-up
Contact with the supplier about an unresolved matter.

accept supplier follow-up

callback commitment
Promise to make a return call at a stated time.

confirm the callback commitment

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

handover pack HANDOVER PACK

confirm the handover pack

Keep the meaning precise: Collection of documents supplied at a project handover.

pin cover PIN COVER

identify the replacement pin cover

Keep the meaning precise: Cover associated with the specified pin or fitting.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

return visit
Later attendance at the property.
arrange a return visit

appointment confirmation
Explicit agreement of a visit arrangement.
await appointment confirmation

warranty document
Written terms describing the applicable warranty.
refer to the warranty document

coverage
Matters included under the stated warranty terms.
verify the documented coverage

exclusion
Matter outside the applicable terms or scope.
check a stated exclusion

document receipt
Confirmation that a document has been received.
record document receipt

part receipt
Confirmation that a component has physically arrived.
verify part receipt

fitting status
Whether the relevant part has been installed or fitted.
confirm fitting status

handover record
Note of documents, completed work, and unresolved items at transfer.
update the handover record

open-item tracker
Record used to follow unresolved matters to completion.
update the open-item tracker

commitment boundary
Limit of what has actually been promised.
preserve the commitment boundary

closure evidence
Information supporting that an item is genuinely complete.
obtain closure evidence

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

callback commitment CALLBACK COMMITMENT
confirm the callback commitment
Keep the meaning precise: Promise to make a return call at a stated time.

exclusion EXCLUSION
check a stated exclusion
Keep the meaning precise: Matter outside the applicable terms or scope.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Confirm the documents

You have the cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet.

State receipt accurately

It is due, but it has not been delivered.

Name the owner

Mina owns that supplier follow-up.

Separate call and visit

Friday is the callback commitment, not a confirmed return visit.

Avoid a delivery promise

I do not have a confirmed arrival date for the cover.

Avoid wider coverage

I am not adding a new warranty promise verbally.

Preserve fitting status

I will not record an undelivered part as fitted.

Avoid premature closure

The cover item stays open pending the actual outcome.

Identify the open item

The replacement shelf pin cover is still outstanding.

Accept ownership

I will follow up with the supplier.

Make the stated commitment

I will call you on Friday.

Keep attendance open

The return-visit date is not confirmed.

Use the supplied terms

The warranty remains as stated in the supplied document.

Keep records separate

Document receipt does not close the outstanding part.

Read back the handover

Documents received, cover outstanding, supplier follow-up with Mina, Friday call.

Close with a clear boundary

The call is committed; delivery and return attendance are not yet confirmed.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Accept ownership
Useful wording: I will follow up with the supplier.

Purpose: Name the owner
Useful wording: Mina owns that supplier follow-up.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which handover summary is correct?

A. Everything delivered and fitted Friday.

B. No documents received.

C. Warranty expanded and supplier delivery guaranteed.

D. Drawings and care sheet received; cover outstanding; Mina follows up and calls Friday; visit unconfirmed.

2. What does Mina's Friday commitment cover?

A. A new warranty term

B. A phone call to Daniel

C. A confirmed installation visit

D. Guaranteed cover delivery

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Confirmation of the surface treatment a document applies to. Which term fits?

A. finish identification

B. warranty document

C. due delivery

D. handover record

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Documents received, one cover outstanding". Daniel: "Who will chase the supplier? I'd prefer one named contact so I don't have to repeat the same question to several people." Mina: [missing response] Daniel: "Can you give me a firm time for the next update, even if the supplier hasn't confirmed the delivery by then?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes. The handover pack documents are with you, including the correct sheet for the finish. The replacement shelf pin cover is still outstanding.

B. I will preserve the commitment boundary. The entry will show supplier follow-up with Mina and a Friday call, with the return visit still unconfirmed.

C. I accept the supplier follow-up. I will contact the supplier about the cover, and the record should name me as the person responsible.

D. Exactly. The care sheet and warranty document have different purposes. Receiving them does not establish that the replacement cover has arrived or been fitted.

Answers and explanations, page 142

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The drawings and correct care sheet are received. The replacement cover is not. Mina accepts supplier follow-up and a Friday call, but no visit date is confirmed. Unlike a requested callback, the Friday call is an explicit commitment in this case.

E Conversation

Documents received, one cover outstanding

Documents received, one cover outstanding

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

open-item tracker / warranty document / appointment confirmation / handover record / handover pack / supplier follow-up / part receipt / care sheet / commitment boundary / callback commitment

01 **Daniel:** I've received the cabinet drawings and care sheet. Before you leave, can we run through the missing cover and the follow-up?

02 **Mina:** Yes. The [1] _____ documents are with you, including the correct sheet for the finish. The replacement shelf pin cover is still outstanding.

03 **Daniel:** It's the replacement shelf-pin cover we're waiting for, correct? I haven't received it just because its name appears in the handover pack.

04 **Mina:** We are waiting for [2] _____. The cover is due, but it has not been delivered. I should not describe it as here or ready to fit.

05 **Daniel:** Who will chase the supplier? I'd prefer one named contact so I don't have to repeat the same question to several people.

06 **Mina:** I accept the [3] _____. I will contact the supplier about the cover, and the record should name me as the person responsible.

07 **Daniel:** Can you give me a firm time for the next update, even if the supplier hasn't confirmed the delivery by then?

08 **Mina:** I will call you on Friday. That is my [4] _____, so you have a definite contact point rather than an open-ended note to wait for news.

09 **Daniel:** When you say Friday, do you mean you'll call, or that someone will come and fit the part? Those are different arrangements for me.

10 **Mina:** It is the call, not [5] _____. No return-visit date is confirmed, and I do not have a confirmed arrival date for the part to give you.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Documents received, one cover outstanding

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Daniel:** Thanks. I won't keep Friday free for a visit. Please make the written note just as clear for anyone else who picks this up.

12 **Mina:** I will preserve the [6] _____. The entry will show supplier follow-up with Mina and a Friday call, with the return visit still unconfirmed.

13 **Daniel:** One more thing: does today's conversation change the warranty? I have the document and don't want to rely on a different verbal promise.

14 **Mina:** The [7] _____ remains the reference. I am not adding broader coverage verbally or changing the terms supplied with your records.

15 **Daniel:** Then I'll keep the finish-care instructions separate from the warranty terms. Neither document confirms that the missing part has arrived.

16 **Mina:** Exactly. The [8] _____ and warranty document have different purposes. Receiving them does not establish that the replacement cover has arrived or been fitted.

17 **Daniel:** Could you read back what is complete and what remains open? I'd like the documents acknowledged without the part being marked done.

18 **Mina:** The [9] _____ says drawings and correct care sheet received; replacement cover outstanding; supplier follow-up owned by Mina; Friday callback committed; return date unconfirmed.

19 **Daniel:** That's clear. Please keep the cover open until its actual outcome is confirmed, and call Friday as agreed even if the delivery is still unresolved.

20 **Mina:** I will retain it in the [10] _____. We can acknowledge the documents received while keeping the part, its follow-up, and any later attendance arrangement visible.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. handover pack / **2.** part receipt / **3.** supplier follow-up / **4.** callback commitment / **5.** appointment confirmation / **6.** commitment boundary / **7.** warranty document / **8.** care sheet / **9.** handover record / **10.** open-item tracker

Why these answers fit, page 143

F Check accuracy and scope

Documents received, one cover outstanding

Return to the case

At a cabinet handover, owner Daniel receives the cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet from joinery lead Mina. A replacement shelf pin cover is due but has not arrived. Mina accepts responsibility for supplier follow-up and commits to calling Daniel on Friday. No return-visit date is confirmed. Warranty terms remain those in the supplied document; Mina must not invent wider coverage or imply that receiving the documents means every outstanding item is complete.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which warranty statement is appropriate?

A. Everything is covered forever.
B. A verbal handover automatically replaces the document.
C. Every outstanding item is excluded without reading the terms.
D. The terms remain those in the supplied document.

2. What is insufficient evidence to close the cover item?

A. Verified actual completion of the relevant follow-up
B. Confirmation of the actual outcome through the project process
C. Evidence that the unresolved item has genuinely been addressed
D. Receipt of the drawings and care sheet alone

Answers and explanations, page 145

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for turns 11-20; make Friday a committed call, not a delivery or visit.

Close completed items without hiding the remainder

A useful handover can acknowledge documents received while retaining an outstanding part and its follow-up. Name the responsible person and the precise commitment. A promise to call is valuable on its own and should not be expanded into a promised visit or changed warranty.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Confirm the promise without expanding it

Complete the handover exchange. Distinguish received documents, the undelivered cover, Mina as owner, and the Friday callback.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

Mina / delivered / received / Friday

01 **Owner:** The drawings and correct care sheet are [1] _____.

02 **Lead:** The replacement cover has not been [2] _____.

03 **Owner:** [3] _____ owns the supplier follow-up.

04 **Lead:** I will call [4] _____; the return visit is not confirmed.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. received / **2.** delivered / **3.** Mina / **4.** Friday

Why these answers fit, page 145

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Documents received, one cover outstanding". Daniel: "One more thing: does today's conversation change the warranty? I have the document and don't want to rely on a different verbal promise." Mina: [missing response] Daniel: "Then I'll keep the finish-care instructions separate from the warranty terms. Neither document confirms that the missing part has arrived." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I accept the supplier follow-up. I will contact the supplier about the cover, and the record should name me as the person responsible.

B. The warranty document remains the reference. I am not adding broader coverage verbally or changing the terms supplied with your records.

C. I will preserve the commitment boundary. The entry will show supplier follow-up with Mina and a Friday call, with the return visit still unconfirmed.

D. Yes. The handover pack documents are with you, including the correct sheet for the finish. The replacement shelf pin cover is still outstanding.

Answers and explanations, page 146

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging" and "Handing over records and return visits". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Adjacent visible face used as a comparison. Which term fits?

A. tolerance
B. drawer runner
C. neighboring front
D. specific exception

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Matter not yet completed, delivered, or resolved. Which term fits?

A. return visit
B. part receipt
C. outstanding item
D. handover pack

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved". Farah: "So the delivery is still Tuesday morning, even though we don't yet have a permitted storage arrangement? Please don't invent a new slot in the update." Ben: [missing response] Farah: "And we can't advertise Tuesday installation just because the material is arriving? The room release is still the missing part." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Purpose-specific access is the key point for the hallway. I will keep the review permission and the storage restriction together whenever I pass the update on.
B. No alternative storage location is confirmed here. I should not invent one or assume that a room available for a discussion can receive the delivery.
C. I have not changed the confirmed delivery. Tuesday morning is still the stated slot. The update flags the mismatch without claiming that a replacement plan exists.
D. The hallway is available for a trim review at 11:00. That is a separate activity, and the hallway is not available for material storage.

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Documents received, one cover outstanding". Daniel: "Could you read back what is complete and what remains open? I'd like the documents acknowledged without the part being marked done." Mina: [missing response] Daniel: "That's clear. Please keep the cover open until its actual outcome is confirmed, and call Friday as agreed even if the delivery is still unresolved." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. The care sheet and warranty document have different purposes. Receiving them does not establish that the replacement cover has arrived or been fitted.

B. Yes. The handover pack documents are with you, including the correct sheet for the finish. The replacement shelf pin cover is still outstanding.

C. I will preserve the commitment boundary. The entry will show supplier follow-up with Mina and a Friday call, with the return visit still unconfirmed.

D. The handover record says drawings and correct care sheet received; replacement cover outstanding; supplier follow-up owned by Mina; Friday callback committed; return date unconfirmed.

Answers and explanations, page 154

Language for the next case

Allow for the missing material

kerf

Kerf is the width of material removed by a cut; the supplied worksheet allows three millimeters for each of three cuts.

Sana: That leaves out the kerf. The worksheet includes three cuts at three millimeters each, so finished pieces aren't the only claim on the usable length.

residual

The supplied requirements total 2,994 millimeters, leaving six from 3,000; fifteen would ignore nine millimeters consumed by the cuts.

Sana: Six is the residual, not fifteen. Keep the cut count and assumed width beside the estimate so someone reviewing it can reproduce the total.

shortfall

Three times 998 plus three times 3 equals 3,003 millimeters, three more than the stated 3,000 available.

Sana: Add the same nine and you need three thousand three. That's a shortfall of three millimeters, even though the finished-piece total alone appears to fit.

finished length

Each required finished piece remains 995 millimeters; adding a material allowance does not authorize shortening that dimension.

Sana: Exactly. The finished length remains nine ninety-five per piece. Accounting for material removed doesn't change what the customer is supposed to receive.

usable length

The 3,000-millimeter figure is explicitly after end preparation; applying an additional invented end allowance would change the supplied estimate.

Sana: Not in this stated worksheet. The usable length already reflects that preparation. An actual plan may need other allowances, but we don't invent them or count the same allowance twice.

cut list

The cut list specifies quantities and finished dimensions; an unresolved material shortage calls for review, not an unauthorized size change.

Sana: Correct. Refer the cut list for review. Don't change the requested lengths, the cut count, or the tool assumption just to force a positive remainder.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Allow for the missing material

Fictional desk estimate only: stock has 3,000 mm usable length after end preparation. The list requires three finished pieces of 995 mm. The worksheet specifies three cuts, each with 3 mm kerf, and no other allowances. The calculation is not a cutting sequence, tool instruction, or permission to change finished dimensions.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

kerf / usable length / residual / shortfall / cut list / finished length

01 **Luca:** Sana, three pieces at nine hundred ninety-five millimeters total twenty-nine eighty-five. I've written fifteen millimeters spare from the three-meter usable stock.

02 **Sana:** That leaves out the [1] _____. The worksheet includes three cuts at three millimeters each, so finished pieces aren't the only claim on the usable length.

03 **Luca:** Right, the cuts consume nine millimeters altogether. I should add those nine to the twenty-nine eighty-five, not subtract them from each finished piece.

04 **Sana:** Exactly. The [2] _____ remains nine ninety-five per piece. Accounting for material removed doesn't change what the customer is supposed to receive.

05 **Luca:** That gives twenty-nine ninety-four required, including the three cuts. Compared with three thousand usable, there's six millimeters remaining.

06 **Sana:** Six is the [3] _____, not fifteen. Keep the cut count and assumed width beside the estimate so someone reviewing it can reproduce the total.

Conversation / continued

07 **Luca:** The three thousand is already after end preparation. Do I deduct another end-preparation amount just to be on the safe side?

08 **Sana:** Not in this stated worksheet. The [4] _____ already reflects that preparation. An actual plan may need other allowances, but we don't invent them or count the same allowance twice.

09 **Luca:** What if the requested pieces change to nine hundred ninety-eight? Three of those total twenty-nine ninety-four before the cuts.

10 **Sana:** Add the same nine and you need three thousand three. That's a [5] _____ of three millimeters, even though the finished-piece total alone appears to fit.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Allow for the missing material

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Luca:** Then silently shaving a millimeter off each finished piece would make the arithmetic fit by changing the requirement. That isn't my decision.

12 **Sana:** Correct. Refer the [6] _____ for review. Don't change the requested lengths, the cut count, or the tool assumption just to force a positive remainder.

13 **Luca:** Is three millimeters the blade plate thickness? The supplier's sheet has separate figures, and I don't want to carry over the wrong one.

14 **Sana:** Kerf and plate thickness are different specifications. Use the relevant verified cut-width information in an actual estimate, not a universal three-millimeter assumption.

15 **Luca:** And this page doesn't tell the workshop how to perform the cuts. It gives a count for arithmetic, not an operating sequence.

16 **Sana:** Yes. Qualified staff still need the actual equipment requirements, safety controls, and production review. This calculation cannot authorize tool use.

17 **Luca:** I'll show the original requirement as three times nine ninety-five plus three times three: twenty-nine ninety-four, leaving six.

18 **Sana:** Then show the proposed nine ninety-eight version separately as three thousand three required. Keeping both versions visible makes the change understandable.

19 **Luca:** No physical production or order change follows from my worksheet. I'm sending the quantity comparison for review.

20 **Sana:** Good. Label the assumptions and preserve the finished dimensions. A clear material estimate explains the constraint without quietly redesigning the parts.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. kerf / **2.** finished length / **3.** residual / **4.** usable length / **5.** shortfall / **6.** cut list

Why these answers fit, page 157

The finished lengths almost fit

A fictional desk worksheet gives 2,400 mm usable stock after end preparation, two finished pieces of 1,198 mm, and two cuts at 3 mm each. No other allowances apply to this exercise.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

2396 / six / 2402 / two

01 **Coordinator:** The two finished lengths total [1] _____ millimeters.

02 **Estimator:** The two cuts consume [2] _____ millimeters.

03 **Coordinator:** The total material requirement is [3] _____ millimeters.

04 **Estimator:** That is [4] _____ millimeters more than the usable stock.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 2396 / **2.** six / **3.** 2402 / **4.** two

Why these answers fit, page 157

> **Keep the distinction audible**
>
> Distinguish finished lengths from cut-width allowance in a supplied material estimate.

Language for the next case

Matching is not the panel order

book matching

Book matching alternates consecutive veneer leaves by turning them over, producing paired mirror-like grain patterns rather than simple repeats.

Joel: Yes. M uses book matching: alternating leaves turn over to form paired, mirror-like patterns. That's the approved appearance reference in this case.

slip matching

Slip matching places successive leaves alongside one another in the same face orientation to repeat the grain pattern; N is not the approved mockup.

Joel: N uses slip matching. Successive leaves sit alongside each other in the same face orientation. We shouldn't record it as approval of M or as an interchangeable name.

viewing direction

Both the required elevation order and photographed order are specified from the finished front, removing a front-versus-back reversal explanation.

Joel: The record confirms the viewing direction is the finished front in both. This isn't a back-view photograph making an otherwise correct order look reversed.

panel sequence

The specified sequence is P11-P12-P13 from the finished front; the recorded P13-P12-P11 layout reverses the outer panels.

Joel: Exactly. The panel sequence doesn't match the elevation. A correct matching method inside each panel wouldn't by itself put those panels in the required order.

orientation

Orientation includes which face and direction a panel is intended to present; the label-order discrepancy alone does not authorize turning or altering panels.

Joel: We need their orientation checked against those records. A panel label discrepancy doesn't tell us that physically turning a panel is the appropriate remedy.

approved mockup

Mockup M is the stated approved reference; N is an unapproved slip-matched alternative, not an equally authorized selection.

Joel: I'll identify the approved mockup as M and the elevation order separately. Species, leaf matching, panel identity, and position are distinct parts of the review.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Matching is not the panel order

Fictional approved mockup M uses book-matched veneer; unapproved alternative N uses slip matching. Viewed from the finished front, the elevation specifies P11 left, P12 center, P13 right. The recorded layout from that same viewpoint is P13, P12, P11. No substitute finish or physical alteration is authorized.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

slip matching / orientation / panel sequence / viewing direction / approved mockup / book matching

01 **Anika:** Joel, the layout photograph looks different from mockup M. Can we separate the veneer pattern from the order of the three panels before discussing a correction?

02 **Joel:** Yes. M uses [1] _____: alternating leaves turn over to form paired, mirror-like patterns. That's the approved appearance reference in this case.

03 **Anika:** The supplier also showed N, where the grain repeats alongside itself. Someone called that another version of the same matching, but it looks different.

04 **Joel:** N uses [2] _____. Successive leaves sit alongside each other in the same face orientation. We shouldn't record it as approval of M or as an interchangeable name.

05 **Anika:** Now the elevation says P11 left, P12 center, P13 right. The photograph labels read P13, P12, P11. Are we definitely looking from the same side?

06 **Joel:** The record confirms the [3] _____ is the finished front in both. This isn't a back-view photograph making an otherwise correct order look reversed.

Conversation / continued

07 **Anika:** Then P12 is in the listed center position, but the two outer panel identifiers are reversed. That's a different issue from leaf matching within a panel.

08 **Joel:** Exactly. The [4] _____ doesn't match the elevation. A correct matching method inside each panel wouldn't by itself put those panels in the required order.

09 **Anika:** Should we turn the outer panels around? I'm wary of giving a quick instruction from a photograph without checking faces, arrows, and the workshop record.

10 **Joel:** We need their [5] _____ checked against those records. A panel label discrepancy doesn't tell us that physically turning a panel is the appropriate remedy.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Matching is not the panel order

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Anika:** Please keep M attached to the query. If the message only says oak veneer, someone could answer about the species and miss the pattern requirement.

12 **Joel:** I'll identify the [6] _____ as M and the elevation order separately. Species, leaf matching, panel identity, and position are distinct parts of the review.

13 **Anika:** So we aren't rejecting every panel or claiming the veneer is defective. We have a pattern reference and a documented placement discrepancy to resolve.

14 **Joel:** Correct. The case doesn't establish a manufacturing defect, the actual grain on every face, or the necessary corrective work. Those need the relevant review.

15 **Anika:** Could the same wood species show different grain even with the requested method? I don't want a promise that every panel will be visually identical.

16 **Joel:** It can. The matching description organizes the appearance; it doesn't promise identical natural grain or cancel the requirement to compare the agreed sample.

17 **Anika:** I'll ask the workshop to reconcile the panel labels, front-view order, and M reference. No permission to substitute N is implied by that question.

18 **Joel:** And no instruction to refinish, re-veneer, or rotate installed work. The review must determine the actual action rather than infer it from our wording.

19 **Anika:** Read-back: book-matched M is approved; slip-matched N isn't. P12 is centered as listed, while P11 and P13 appear in opposite outer positions.

20 **Joel:** That's the distinction we need. I'll preserve the photograph viewpoint and original identifiers so the response addresses both the appearance reference and the sequence.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. book matching / **2.** slip matching / **3.** viewing direction / **4.** panel sequence / **5.** orientation / **6.** approved mockup

Why these answers fit, page 159

Check the center and right labels

A fictional front elevation requires P21 left, P22 center, P23 right. The recorded finished-front order is P21, P23, P22. Mockup Q calls for paired mirror-like grain from alternately turned consecutive leaves, not same-face repeats.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

P23 / book matching / P22 / slip matching

01 **Designer:** The required center panel is [1] _____ .

02 **Coordinator:** The required right panel is [2] _____ .

03 **Designer:** Q specifies [3] _____ .

04 **Coordinator:** Same-face grain repeats describe [4] _____ instead.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. P22 / **2.** P23 / **3.** book matching / **4.** slip matching

Why these answers fit, page 159

Keep the distinction audible

Describe veneer-leaf matching and panel placement without confusing the two.

Language for the next case

A percentage needs its basis

moisture content

Wood moisture content here is water mass divided by oven-dry wood mass, expressed as a percentage, not the absolute grams of water alone.

Marcus: Compare moisture content, not just the grams lost. For A, subtract one hundred twenty from one hundred thirty-two, then divide the twelve by one hundred twenty.

dry-mass basis

The supplied formula uses the 120-gram oven-dry mass for A; dividing by the original mass would answer a different question.

Marcus: Yes, the dry-mass basis matters. A percentage without its basis could make a correct-looking report refer to the wrong calculation.

percentage

B is 12.5 percent and A is 10 percent on the same dry-mass basis, despite B containing fewer absolute grams of water.

Marcus: Correct. B has a higher percentage even though it contains fewer grams of water. The samples have different dry masses, so the absolute losses aren't directly comparable as percentages.

screening result

A meets the fictional 8-12 percent sample interval; B at 12.5 percent does not, without establishing a cause or overall installation fitness.

Marcus: That's the screening result. Keep each sample's result visible. This interval comes from our project specification; it isn't a rule for every wood product.

individual limit

The stated requirement applies to each sample, so averaging 10 and 12.5 to 11.25 cannot erase B's individual result above twelve.

Marcus: Not under this individual limit. Averaging can hide B's failure to meet the stated range; it doesn't change the requirement from each sample to the mean.

Relative humidity

Relative humidity describes the surrounding air, whereas wood moisture content describes water relative to dry wood mass; their percentages are not interchangeable.

Marcus: No. Relative humidity is an air condition. Wood moisture is a different quantity, and neither of these two sample percentages supplies the room's air reading.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

A percentage needs its basis

Fictional completed laboratory results: sample A originally 132 g, oven-dry 120 g; B originally 90 g, oven-dry 80 g. Moisture content = (original minus dry mass) / dry mass x 100. This project's screening range is 8-12% inclusive for each sample. No laboratory procedure or installation approval is provided.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

individual limit / dry-mass basis / screening result / moisture content / percentage / Relative humidity

01 **Noor:** Marcus, A lost twelve grams and B lost ten. I nearly described B as the drier sample, but their original sizes are different.

02 **Marcus:** Compare [1] _____, not just the grams lost. For A, subtract one hundred twenty from one hundred thirty-two, then divide the twelve by one hundred twenty.

03 **Noor:** That gives zero point one, or ten percent. The denominator is the dry mass, not the original one hundred thirty-two grams.

04 **Marcus:** Yes, the [2] _____ matters. A percentage without its basis could make a correct-looking report refer to the wrong calculation.

05 **Noor:** For B, ninety minus eighty is ten grams. Ten divided by eighty is zero point one two five, so twelve point five percent.

06 **Marcus:** Correct. B has a higher [3] _____ even though it contains fewer grams of water. The samples have different dry masses, so the absolute losses aren't directly comparable as percentages.

Conversation / continued

07 **Noor:** Our project sheet says eight to twelve percent inclusive for each sample. A is inside that interval, but B is half a percentage point above the upper limit.

08 **Marcus:** That's the [4] _____. Keep each sample's result visible. This interval comes from our project specification; it isn't a rule for every wood product.

09 **Noor:** Their simple average is eleven point two five. Could someone use that number to say the samples pass together?

10 **Marcus:** Not under this [5] _____. Averaging can hide B's failure to meet the stated range; it doesn't change the requirement from each sample to the mean.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A percentage needs its basis

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Noor:** The site email also says relative humidity. A at ten percent doesn't mean the room air was ten percent relative humidity, does it?

12 **Marcus:** No. [6] _____ is an air condition. Wood moisture is a different quantity, and neither of these two sample percentages supplies the room's air reading.

13 **Noor:** What about equilibrium moisture content? Does leaving boards in a room for two days establish that they've reached it?

14 **Marcus:** No fixed two-day rule is supplied. Equilibrium concerns balance with the surrounding conditions, including temperature and humidity, not simply elapsed time.

15 **Noor:** Then the note shouldn't say the whole delivery is acclimated and ready because one sample meets the range. We have only the supplied sample results.

16 **Marcus:** Exactly. The actual sampling plan, material requirements, site conditions, and qualified review still matter. Passing this arithmetic check isn't permission to install.

17 **Noor:** And B's result doesn't identify why it is higher or prove that the material has decay. It tells us how it compares with this stated interval.

18 **Marcus:** Correct. Report the values and refer the discrepancy; don't invent a cause, a drying method, or a structural conclusion from these two numbers.

19 **Noor:** I'll record A: ten percent, within range; B: twelve point five, above range; both calculated using oven-dry mass. Overall release remains unconfirmed.

20 **Marcus:** Good. Keep the original and dry masses with the results. That makes the calculation traceable while leaving the actual material decision to the appropriate review.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. moisture content / **2.** dry-mass basis / **3.** percentage / **4.** screening result / **5.** individual limit / **6.** Relative humidity

Why these answers fit, page 161

Different masses, same basis

Completed fictional results: C originally 165 g, oven-dry 150 g; D originally 113 g, oven-dry 100 g. Use (original minus dry) / dry x 100. Each sample must meet this project's 8-12% inclusive screening interval; overall release is not supplied.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

10 / above / 15 / 13

01 **Coordinator:** C contains [1] _____ grams of water in the reported calculation.

02 **Lead:** C has [2] _____ percent moisture on the dry-mass basis.

03 **Coordinator:** D has [3] _____ percent moisture on the same basis.

04 **Lead:** D is [4] _____ the stated screening interval.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. 15 / **2.** 10 / **3.** 13 / **4.** above

Why these answers fit, page 161

Keep the distinction audible

Explain wood moisture on a dry-mass basis and keep sample screening distinct from installation approval.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What does the drawing label say?

B. Door opening: 900 millimeters, without a rough or finished reference

The note supplies a number but does not identify the opening reference.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. What is Hana assuming?

D. That 900 millimeters is clear passage width

Hana reads the number as usable passage, which has not been established.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What is the appropriate next step?

B. Ask Priya to clarify the measurement reference

Priya can clarify the reference; the conversation does not establish an order size or compliance.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which question targets the missing information?

A. Does 900 millimeters refer to the rough opening, finished opening, or another reference?

The question asks what the stated dimension describes without assuming an interpretation.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. Which reassurance is unsupported?

C. You will definitely have 900 millimeters of usable passage.

The note does not establish usable passage, so the reassurance exceeds the evidence.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Unobstructed usable space through an opening under the stated conditions. Which term fits?

B. clear passage

A Not here. datum: Stated reference point, line, or level for measurements. The usual combination is "confirm the datum".

B Correct. clear passage: Unobstructed usable space through an opening under the stated conditions. The usual combination is "confirm the clear passage".

C Not here. threshold: Lower part at the base of a doorway. The usual combination is "refer to the threshold".

D Not here. drawing note: Written instruction or information on a drawing. The usual combination is "clarify the drawing note".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "What does 900 millimeters describe?". Hana: "When you say rough, do you mean the measurement isn't accurate? I'd prefer an exact figure before we choose anything." Ellis: [missing response] Hana: "I see. So which surfaces does this particular arrow measure between? The drawing isn't clear enough for me to tell." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. No, rough opening describes the structural opening before the assembly and relevant finishes. Rough names a construction stage here, not a rough guess.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Hana says: "Can Priya settle the meaning? She prepared the design, and I'd like her to understand why I'm asking about the space." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Hana says: "I see. So which surfaces does this particular arrow measure between? The drawing isn't clear enough for me to tell." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Hana says: "Right, I'm interested in the gap I can actually use, not the width of the door leaf. Have I been reading the wrong measurement?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Ellis's response in turn 6. It connects Hana's preceding point with Hana's follow-up. Rough opening refers to the structural opening before the assembly and relevant finishes, not an approximate estimate of usable width.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. dimension reference

Turn 2. Dimension reference identifies what the 900-millimeter figure measures, which the current note does not make clear.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. clear passage

Turn 4. Clear passage is the usable unobstructed space Hana wants to understand, not automatically the dimension on the drawing.

3. rough opening

Turn 6. Rough opening refers to the structural opening before the assembly and relevant finishes, not an approximate estimate of usable width.

4. reference face

Turn 8. Reference face names a surface used for measurement; the drawing note does not identify those surfaces clearly.

5. order size

Turn 10. Order size is not established by the ambiguous note, and no door has been ordered in this case.

6. designer clarification

Turn 12. Designer clarification is the appropriate route for resolving the intended measurement reference without a guessed interpretation.

7. opening dimension

Turn 14. Opening dimension remains the stated 900 millimeters; the query concerns its meaning rather than a requested numerical change.

8. door frame

Turn 16. Door frame is a distinct component whose dimensions must not be silently equated with usable passage or the ambiguous opening note.

9. drawing note

Turn 18. Drawing note needs an explanation of its measurement reference; the clarification conversation is not a compliance assessment.

10. actual dimension

Turn 20. Actual dimension of the usable passage is not verified; the next step is clarification, not a width guarantee or product order.

Return to the conversation, page 10

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What should remain unchanged in the query?

C. The stated 900-millimeter figure and the uncertainty about its reference

The query preserves the actual figure while asking for its unresolved meaning.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F2. Which distinction matters for ordering?

C. An unclear opening note is not a confirmed door order size.

The dimension reference must be clarified before it can support an appropriate product specification.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F / Guided speaking

1. 900

Client: The drawing says 900 millimeters.

Turn 1. The stated figure is 900 millimeters, although its reference is unclear.

2. finished

Carpenter: The note does not identify rough or finished opening.

Turn 2. Finished is the alternative opening reference the note does not clarify.

3. passage

Client: My concern is the clear passage.

Turn 3. Passage identifies the usable space Hana wants to understand.

4. designer

Carpenter: I will ask the designer to clarify the reference.

Turn 4. The designer can clarify the intended reference without the carpenter inventing it.

Return to the conversation, page 13

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "What does 900 millimeters describe?". Hana: "Please don't change 900 to a different number in the message. I'm asking what it means, not instructing her to redesign it." Ellis: [missing response] Hana: "Would the frame take some of that space? I'm not asking you to work it out now, but I don't want it overlooked." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Agreed. I'll quote the opening dimension of 900 millimeters exactly and ask which construction stage and measurement surfaces it refers to.

A Correct. This is Ellis's response in turn 14. It connects Hana's preceding point with Hana's follow-up. Opening dimension remains the stated 900 millimeters; the query concerns its meaning rather than a requested numerical change.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Hana says: "And we're not confirming that the doorway meets a particular access requirement today? I don't want to pass that on as settled." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Hana says: "Right, I'm interested in the gap I can actually use, not the width of the door leaf. Have I been reading the wrong measurement?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Hana says: "Has anyone already bought a door against that number? I'd rather raise it now than discover it doesn't give us the passage we need." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 13

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which description belongs to sample A?

C. Solid oak, pronounced grain, ten-day quoted lead time

Sample A has the specified solid-oak construction, pronounced grain, and ten-day quote.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A2. What do the samples have in common?

C. Both match the requested profile

The shared attribute is the requested profile, not construction, appearance, or timing.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A3. What remains undecided?

A. Which sample to select

No selection has been made, although the comparison attributes are stated.

Return to the exercise, page 14

D / Response choices

D1. Which comparison is fully supported?

B. A is solid oak with pronounced grain and ten days; B is veneered with a more uniform look and four days.

The comparison uses the stated construction, appearance, and quoted timing without adding unsupported claims.

Return to the exercise, page 18

D2. Which attribute does not distinguish the samples?

A. The requested profile, which both match

Both samples meet the requested profile, so it is their shared attribute.

Return to the exercise, page 18

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Wood prepared or used for building and joinery. Which term fits?

B. timber

A Not here. uniform appearance: More consistent visual character across the sample. The usual combination is "describe a uniform appearance".

B Correct. timber: Wood prepared or used for building and joinery. The usual combination is "specify the timber".

C Not here. visual preference: Appearance favored by the client. The usual combination is "clarify the visual preference".

D Not here. clear finish: Coating that allows underlying material to remain visible. The usual combination is "specify a clear finish".

Return to the exercise, page 18

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two oak samples, different trade-offs". Oliver: "So B has real oak on the surface, over something else? What is underneath it, or don't we have that specification here?" Mei: [missing response] Oliver: "Remind me which one has the shorter lead time. I don't want to mistake a supplier quote for the day you'll fit it." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Yes, oak veneer refers to that surface layer. I do not have a specification for the supporting material here, so I should not name a core that is not listed.

A Correct. This is Mei's response in turn 6. It connects Oliver's preceding point with Oliver's follow-up. Oak veneer is the thin oak surface layer over a supporting material; it is not the same construction as solid oak.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Oliver says: "Both shapes look right for the study. Before I choose, what is actually different between these samples apart from the price, which I haven't seen?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Oliver says: "Let me read that back: A, solid oak, stronger grain, ten days; B, veneered, more uniform, four days. Neither has an installation booking." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Oliver says: "Can you keep the finish details and prices as outstanding questions? They matter to the decision as well as the grain and lead time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 18

E / Conversation

1. material construction

Turn 2. Material construction distinguishes solid oak in A from oak veneer over a supporting material in B.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. pronounced grain

Turn 4. Pronounced grain describes the stronger visible pattern on sample A without making a quality or durability claim.

3. oak veneer

Turn 6. Oak veneer is the thin oak surface layer over a supporting material; it is not the same construction as solid oak.

4. quoted lead time

Turn 8. Quoted lead time is ten days for A and four for B; these figures do not establish installation appointments.

5. visual preference

Turn 10. Visual preference concerns the appearance Oliver favors and remains one consideration alongside the stated timing and construction.

6. profile

Turn 12. Profile is the cross-sectional shape, which both samples match; it is not a difference between these options.

7. performance claim

Turn 14. Performance claim would assert durability or function not supplied by the sample comparison; material names alone do not establish it.

8. selection status

Turn 16. Selection status remains undecided; Oliver's favorable comment about A is not approval or an order instruction.

9. sample approval

Turn 18. Sample approval has not been given; the missing comparisons and Oliver's final choice remain unresolved.

10. installation date

Turn 20. Installation date is not supplied by either lead-time quote, and no sample selection or fitting appointment is confirmed.

Return to the conversation, page 20

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which statement overgeneralizes?

C. Veneered trim always arrives in four days.

The four-day quote belongs to sample B, not every veneered product.

Return to the exercise, page 22

F2. How should Mei record Oliver's interest in A?

A. A is under discussion; no selection has been made.

Interest or discussion alone does not establish selection, purchase, or installation.

Return to the exercise, page 22

F / Guided speaking

1. oak

Carpenter: Sample A is solid oak.

Turn 1. Oak is the stated solid material used for sample A.

2. uniform

Client: B has the more uniform appearance.

Turn 2. Uniform describes B relative to the pronounced grain of A.

3. four

Carpenter: B has a quoted four-day lead time.

Turn 3. Four days is B's quoted supply interval, not an installation date.

4. selected

Client: Neither sample is selected yet.

Turn 4. No selection has been made despite discussion of both samples.

Return to the conversation, page 23

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two oak samples, different trade-offs". Oliver: "Do we have prices or durability information yet? I don't want to assume veneered automatically means cheaper or less hard-wearing." Mei: [missing response] Oliver: "I'm leaning toward A, but please don't order it on that basis. I still need the missing details before I approve anything." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. We do not have a price comparison. I also cannot support a performance claim about which lasts longer from the information on these two samples.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Oliver says: "I'm leaning toward A, but please don't order it on that basis. I still need the missing details before I approve anything." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Oliver says: "That makes B six days quicker on the quote. I still prefer A's grain, so I'm not ready to choose on timing alone." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Mei's response in turn 14. It connects Oliver's preceding point with Oliver's follow-up. Performance claim would assert durability or function not supplied by the sample comparison; material names alone do not establish it.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Oliver says: "A's grain stands out much more against this wall color. B looks quieter. Is that just what we're seeing in these particular pieces?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 23

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What conflict is shown?

A. C4 revision B gives 20 millimeters; S2 revision B gives 15 at the same panel

The two revision-B sheets give different reveal values at the same end panel.

Return to the exercise, page 26

A2. What is due at 14:00?

A. The fabrication-release review

The supplied time belongs to the review, not a promised answer or completed fabrication.

Return to the exercise, page 26

A3. Who has not yet clarified the dimension?

A. The designer

The designer has not resolved which dimension applies.

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D / Response choices

D1. Which query is complete?

A. At the same end panel, C4 rev B shows 20 mm and S2 rev B shows 15 mm; please clarify for the 14:00 release review.

The complete query includes location, both references, conflicting values, and the review time.

Return to the exercise, page 30

D2. Which proposed shortcut is unsupported?

A. Average the values and fabricate a 17.5-millimeter reveal.

No authority is given to invent a midpoint or release fabrication from conflicting dimensions.

Return to the exercise, page 30

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Panel forming or covering an exposed end of cabinetry. Which term fits?

B. end panel

A Not here. unresolved detail: Information point not yet clarified. The usual combination is "flag an unresolved detail".

B Correct. end panel: Panel forming or covering an exposed end of cabinetry. The usual combination is "identify the end panel".

C Not here. design intent: Intended design result communicated through the project information. The usual combination is "clarify the design intent".

D Not here. release review: Review of readiness or permission to issue work for the next stage. The usual combination is "attend the release review".

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D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two reveals on revision B". Arun: "Still waiting. The workshop has asked which figure to use. I can't choose twenty just because the elevation is the clearer view." Lena: [missing response] Arun: "Someone thought S2 might be the old sheet. Both labels say B, though, and I haven't found anything establishing that either has been replaced." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Nor can we choose fifteen for convenience. We need a clarification response identifying the intended value and the detail it applies to.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Arun says: "And ask specifically for the reveal. I don't want this turned into a request to recheck every dimension in the cabinet package." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Arun says: "Elevation C4, revision B: twenty millimeters. Section S2, also revision B: fifteen. I've checked that they point to this same end panel." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Arun says: "Someone thought S2 might be the old sheet. Both labels say B, though, and I haven't found anything establishing that either has been replaced." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Lena's response in turn 6. It connects Arun's preceding point with Arun's follow-up. Clarification response must resolve the intended dimension; convenience or drawing readability does not establish the correct value.

Return to the exercise, page 30

E / Conversation

1. sheet number

Turn 2. Sheet number locates each drawing precisely for the designer's review of the conflict.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. dimension discrepancy

Turn 4. Dimension discrepancy is 20 versus 15 millimeters at the same end panel, not two unrelated measurements.

3. clarification response

Turn 6. Clarification response must resolve the intended dimension; convenience or drawing readability does not establish the correct value.

4. superseded drawing

Turn 8. Superseded drawing would mean an earlier issue had been replaced; the shared B labels do not establish that status.

5. review deadline

Turn 10. Review deadline is 14:00 for the fabrication-release review, not an agreed designer-response time or automatic production permission.

6. drawing conflict

Turn 12. Drawing conflict keeps both incompatible values and their references visible in the handoff.

7. applicable dimension

Turn 14. Applicable dimension concerns the reveal at this end panel, not every cabinet measurement.

8. unresolved detail

Turn 16. Unresolved detail keeps the unanswered reveal question visible instead of allowing silence to imply that it has been settled.

9. design intent

Turn 18. Design intent requires clarification; averaging the conflicting values invents a result instead of establishing it.

10. fabrication release

Turn 20. Fabrication release is not granted here; the reveal still requires designer clarification.

Return to the conversation, page 32

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What do the revision labels establish?

C. Both sheets are marked B, not which dimension is correct

The shared letter does not identify precedence or resolve the inconsistent detail.

Return to the exercise, page 34

F2. Which status is accurate at the end?

D. The reveal remains unresolved and fabrication is not authorized by this conversation.

No designer clarification or fabrication authorization is supplied during the exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 34

F / Guided speaking

1. C4

Carpenter: Elevation C4 revision B shows 20 millimeters.

Turn 1. C4 is the elevation reference carrying the 20-millimeter reveal.

2. 15

Coordinator: Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters.

Turn 2. Fifteen millimeters is the conflicting value on section S2.

3. panel

Carpenter: Both refer to the same end panel.

Turn 3. The shared panel location is why the values conflict.

4. clarified

Coordinator: The designer has not yet clarified the applicable dimension.

Turn 4. No clarification has resolved the conflict or authorized a dimension.

Return to the conversation, page 35

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two reveals on revision B". Arun: "And ask specifically for the reveal. I don't want this turned into a request to recheck every dimension in the cabinet package." Lena: [missing response] Arun: "If the answer hasn't arrived by the review, what goes in the record? Leaving the box empty could make it look resolved." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Agreed. The applicable dimension is the reveal at this location. A precise query doesn't imply we've verified the rest of the package.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Arun says: "Someone thought S2 might be the old sheet. Both labels say B, though, and I haven't found anything establishing that either has been replaced." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Arun says: "Elevation C4, revision B: twenty millimeters. Section S2, also revision B: fifteen. I've checked that they point to this same end panel." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Arun says: "Still waiting. The workshop has asked which figure to use. I can't choose twenty just because the elevation is the clearer view." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Lena's response in turn 14. It connects Arun's preceding point with Arun's follow-up. Applicable dimension concerns the reveal at this end panel, not every cabinet measurement.

Return to the exercise, page 35

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is visible?

B. Dark staining on exposed subfloor beside the laundry doorway

Only the staining on the exposed subfloor is directly visible.

Return to the exercise, page 36

A2. What limits Nia's conclusion?

D. The joists are not visible and structural condition has not been assessed

The concealed joists and lack of structural assessment prevent a supported diagnosis.

Return to the exercise, page 36

A3. What can Sam arrange?

B. A qualified assessment

Sam can arrange assessment, but no finding, repair, or price is supplied.

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D / Response choices

D1. Which report separates observation from diagnosis?

D. Dark staining is visible on the subfloor; the concealed joists have not been assessed.

The report states the visible fact and preserves the unassessed concealed condition.

Return to the exercise, page 40

D2. Which answer to Theo is unsupported?

D. The joists are definitely sound because we cannot see damage.

Inability to see the joists cannot establish that they are structurally sound.

Return to the exercise, page 40

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Area visible after a covering is absent or removed. Which term fits?

C. exposed surface

A Not here. qualified assessor: Person competent to examine the relevant condition. The usual combination is "refer to a qualified assessor".

B Not here. structural condition: State of components relevant to carrying loads. The usual combination is "request assessment of structural condition".

C Correct. exposed surface: Area visible after a covering is absent or removed. The usual combination is "describe the exposed surface".

D Not here. investigation status: Current stage of checking an unresolved concern. The usual combination is "report the investigation status".

Return to the exercise, page 40

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Staining is not a structural finding". Theo: "So you can record the stain, but not my guess about what caused it as though it's a finding?" Nia: [missing response] Theo: "Could it be coming from the laundry? That was my first thought because it's so close to the doorway." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Exactly. I'll separate the site observation from your question: visible discoloration here, and a concern about the condition of the concealed joists.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Theo says: "Nia, this dark patch by the laundry door looks worrying. Is that rot in the joists, or am I jumping to conclusions?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Theo says: "Who should look into it? I'd like someone qualified to assess it before I'm told the floor needs replacing." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 6. It connects Theo's preceding point with Theo's follow-up. Site observation preserves the visible staining and its location without turning the client's proposed explanation into a diagnosis.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Theo says: "I thought what we're looking at might be the joists themselves. Are those different from this exposed layer?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 40

E / Conversation

1. dark staining

Turn 2. Dark staining is the observed discoloration on the exposed subfloor, not a confirmed finding of decay in concealed joists.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. subfloor

Turn 4. Subfloor is the visible supporting floor layer in this case, distinct from the concealed joists about which Theo asks.

3. site observation

Turn 6. Site observation preserves the visible staining and its location without turning the client's proposed explanation into a diagnosis.

4. moisture source

Turn 8. Moisture source has not been established; the question about water does not prove where it came from or what it affected.

5. qualified assessor

Turn 10. Qualified assessor is the appropriate person to examine the relevant concern; no completed assessment or finding exists yet.

6. repair proposal

Turn 12. Repair proposal is not established by requesting an assessment; replacement, cost, and disruption have not been determined.

7. visibility limit

Turn 14. Visibility limit prevents both a confirmed decay diagnosis and a claim that concealed structural members are sound.

8. investigation status

Turn 16. Investigation status remains unassessed for structural condition; describing staining is not equivalent to completing an inspection.

9. laundry doorway

Turn 18. Laundry doorway is the specific location of the observation, allowing the referral to identify the relevant area accurately.

10. referral route

Turn 20. Referral route passes the concern to Sam for arranging qualified assessment, without inventing a diagnosis or authorizing a repair.

Return to the conversation, page 42

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which location should the referral include?

D. Beside the laundry doorway

The supplied location helps the assessor identify the actual observed area.

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F2. What remains unknown?

C. The cause, concealed structural condition, and any required repair

No assessment has established the cause, structural condition, or appropriate repair.

Return to the exercise, page 44

F / Guided speaking

1. subfloor

Carpenter: Dark staining is visible on the exposed subfloor.

Turn 1. Subfloor is the visible layer carrying the reported staining.

2. visible

Client: The joists are not visible.

Turn 2. The joists remain concealed, so their condition cannot be judged from this view.

3. assessed

Carpenter: Structural condition has not been assessed.

Turn 3. No structural assessment has occurred in the supplied case facts.

4. assessment

Client: Please ask Sam to arrange a qualified assessment.

Turn 4. Assessment is the available next step, not a confirmed diagnosis or repair.

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04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Staining is not a structural finding". Theo: "Would it be reasonable to say the joists are probably fine until someone finds damage? Or is that going too far as well?" Nia: [missing response] Theo: "All right. Please don't describe today's conversation as a structural inspection. I can imagine that getting repeated later as an all-clear." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The visibility limit works both ways. I can't confirm decay, but hidden joists also prevent me from assuring you that the structure is sound.

A Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 14. It connects Theo's preceding point with Theo's follow-up. Visibility limit prevents both a confirmed decay diagnosis and a claim that concealed structural members are sound.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Theo says: "Who should look into it? I'd like someone qualified to assess it before I'm told the floor needs replacing." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Theo says: "I thought what we're looking at might be the joists themselves. Are those different from this exposed layer?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Theo says: "Could it be coming from the laundry? That was my first thought because it's so close to the doorway." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 45

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is included in the current scope?

D. Replacing bedroom skirting only

The agreed scope is limited to replacing the bedroom skirting.

Return to the exercise, page 48

A2. What is the new request?

A. A built-in bench

Amara requests a built-in bench in addition to the existing work.

Return to the exercise, page 48

A3. What can Jules arrange?

A. A separate quotation, with dimensions, price, and date still unagreed

The separate quotation route is available, but the bench terms have not been established.

Return to the exercise, page 48

D / Response choices

D1. Which scope summary is accurate?

B. Skirting replacement only; decorating excluded; bench requested separately.

The summary preserves the existing task, the exclusion, and the separate new request.

Return to the exercise, page 52

D2. Which response is helpful without overpromising?

A. I can arrange a separate quotation, with dimensions and timing still to be agreed.

The quotation route acknowledges the request while preserving the unresolved bench details.

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05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Work explicitly included in the current agreement. Which term fits?

A. agreed scope

A Correct. agreed scope: Work explicitly included in the current agreement. The usual combination is "confirm the agreed scope".

B Not here. measurement visit: Attendance to establish relevant dimensions. The usual combination is "discuss a measurement visit".

C Not here. quotation scope: Tasks and terms covered by a price proposal. The usual combination is "define the quotation scope".

D Not here. bench dimensions: Measurements defining the proposed bench. The usual combination is "agree the bench dimensions".

Return to the exercise, page 52

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A bench beyond the skirting scope". Amara: "Could I get a separate price before I decide? I'm asking for an option, not telling you to start building it." Jules: [missing response] Amara: "I haven't settled the length or depth. When I pointed at the wall, I didn't mean that the bench must fill the whole space." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I can arrange a separate quotation. Asking for that quote does not mean you have approved the bench or agreed to pay an amount we have not supplied.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Amara says: "While you're doing the bedroom skirting, could you also build a bench along that wall? I'm wondering whether it could be added to this visit." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Jules's response in turn 6. It connects Amara's preceding point with Amara's follow-up. Separate quotation is the available route for pricing the bench request; it is not an accepted price or permission to begin.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Amara says: "What about painting? I know decorating isn't in the present booking. Would a bench quote need to say explicitly whether finishing is included?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Amara says: "I realize it isn't another piece of skirting. I thought being here already might make it simpler, but I haven't worked out the details." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 52

E / Conversation

1. agreed scope

Turn 2. Agreed scope is bedroom skirting replacement only; the bench request does not automatically belong to that agreement.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. additional work

Turn 4. Additional work describes the bench beyond the existing skirting task, even though both would be in the same bedroom.

3. separate quotation

Turn 6. Separate quotation is the available route for pricing the bench request; it is not an accepted price or permission to begin.

4. bench dimensions

Turn 8. Bench dimensions are not agreed; a pointing gesture does not establish length, depth, height, or a final design.

5. scope exclusion

Turn 10. Scope exclusion keeps decorating outside the existing booking; the bench discussion does not silently add painting or other finishing work.

6. quotation scope

Turn 12. Quotation scope identifies what a proposed price covers, including any stated finish requirements, rather than relying on an unstated assumption.

7. completion commitment

Turn 14. Completion commitment for the bench is absent; interest in the idea and a quotation referral do not establish a finish date.

8. existing contract

Turn 16. Existing contract continues to cover the skirting replacement; discussing a bench does not cancel or replace that task.

9. Change authorization

Turn 18. Change authorization has not been given; a future decision would need to establish the additional work through the relevant process.

10. scope handoff

Turn 20. Scope handoff transfers the bench request with its unresolved dimensions, price, and timing while preserving the skirting-only agreement.

Return to the conversation, page 54

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What does requesting a quote establish?

D. Interest in having the extra work priced, not approval to perform it

A quotation request is not acceptance of terms or authorization of the additional work.

Return to the exercise, page 56

F2. Which item must remain excluded from the current booking?

A. Decorating

Decorating is explicitly excluded and is not added by the bench discussion.

Return to the exercise, page 56

F / Guided speaking

1. skirting

Carpenter: The agreed task is replacing the skirting.

Turn 1. Skirting replacement is the only work included in the current agreement.

2. excluded

Client: Decorating remains excluded.

Turn 2. The current booking excludes decorating, even after the bench question.

3. quotation

Carpenter: I can arrange a separate quotation for the bench.

Turn 3. A quotation can be arranged without approving or pricing the work now.

4. agreed

Client: The bench dimensions are not yet agreed.

Turn 4. No bench measurements have been established or accepted during the conversation.

Return to the conversation, page 57

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A bench beyond the skirting scope". Amara: "Could it be finished this week? I'm asking whether that's possible, but I don't want you to put a date into the quote without checking." Jules: [missing response] Amara: "Then today's skirting job stays as agreed while the bench is priced separately. Is there anything in this discussion that changes the existing booking?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. No completion commitment has been made for the bench. I cannot give you a confirmed date before the proposed work and arrangements are agreed.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Amara says: "Then today's skirting job stays as agreed while the bench is priced separately. Is there anything in this discussion that changes the existing booking?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Amara says: "Yes, I'd rather see what's covered than compare prices that mean different things. The finish could affect which proposal I accept." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Amara says: "I haven't settled the length or depth. When I pointed at the wall, I didn't mean that the bench must fill the whole space." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Jules's response in turn 14. It connects Amara's preceding point with Amara's follow-up. Completion commitment for the bench is absent; interest in the idea and a quotation referral do not establish a finish date.

Return to the exercise, page 57

06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What is confirmed?

A. Joinery delivery for Tuesday morning

Only the delivery arrangement is confirmed for Tuesday morning.

Return to the exercise, page 58

A2. What remains unresolved?

D. The decorator has not released the study for carpentry access

Study access is unresolved because the decorator has not released that area.

Return to the exercise, page 58

A3. What is the hallway available for?

B. A separate trim review at 11:00, not storage

The hallway permission is specific to the trim review and excludes material storage.

Return to the exercise, page 58

D / Response choices

D1. Which status report is accurate?

C. Tuesday-morning delivery confirmed; study access unreleased; hallway review at 11:00; no hallway storage.

The report preserves each arrangement and the specific hallway restriction.

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D2. Which inference is unsupported?

B. A confirmed delivery means the study is ready for installation.

Delivery and room access are separate arrangements, so one does not prove the other.

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06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Confirmation that a defined area is available for the specified work. Which term fits?

D. access release

A Not here. storage permission: Authorization to leave materials in a defined location. The usual combination is "confirm storage permission".

B Not here. storage location: Place where materials may be held. The usual combination is "confirm the storage location".

C Not here. installation access: Availability of an area for fitting work. The usual combination is "verify installation access".

D Correct. access release: Confirmation that a defined area is available for the specified work. The usual combination is "request an access release".

Return to the exercise, page 62

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved". Farah: "Then what exactly is booked for eleven in the hallway? The word access in the message is a bit too broad for me." Ben: [missing response] Farah: "Can the joinery wait in the hallway until the study is released? I'm asking before anyone puts that location on the delivery instructions." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. The hallway is available for a trim review at 11:00. That is a separate activity, and the hallway is not available for material storage.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Farah says: "Do we know when the study will be released? If not, keep that unknown rather than using eleven o'clock as a convenient estimate." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 6. It connects Farah's preceding point with Farah's follow-up. Trim review is the specific activity allowed in the hallway at 11:00; it is not a material-storage arrangement.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Farah says: "Is the decorator finished with the study? I don't want the delivery confirmation to be read as permission for the installers to enter that room." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Farah says: "Can the joinery wait in the hallway until the study is released? I'm asking before anyone puts that location on the delivery instructions." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 62

E / Conversation

1. delivery slot

Turn 2. Delivery slot is Tuesday morning for the joinery; it does not establish room access, storage permission, or installation readiness.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. access release

Turn 4. Access release for the study has not been given, and no release time is supplied in the case.

3. trim review

Turn 6. Trim review is the specific activity allowed in the hallway at 11:00; it is not a material-storage arrangement.

4. storage location

Turn 8. Storage location is not confirmed elsewhere, and the hallway is explicitly excluded from material storage.

5. confirmed delivery

Turn 10. Confirmed delivery remains Tuesday morning; reporting the access conflict does not itself reschedule the supplier.

6. Installation access

Turn 12. Installation access is unresolved because the study has not been released; a delivered product does not authorize fitting work there.

7. logistics update

Turn 14. Logistics update reports the actual arrangements and unresolved dependency without inventing a cause or blaming another trade.

8. status readback

Turn 16. Status readback repeats delivery, access, review, and storage separately so no permission is lost or expanded in the handoff.

9. schedule dependency

Turn 18. Schedule dependency is the unresolved study access, which remains distinct from the already confirmed delivery and review arrangements.

10. Purpose-specific access

Turn 20. Purpose-specific access limits the hallway arrangement to the trim review; it does not authorize storage or substitute for study access.

Return to the conversation, page 64

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What can Farah coordinate next?

A. The unresolved study-access arrangement

Farah needs the unresolved access dependency, not an unauthorized substitute arrangement.

Return to the exercise, page 66

F2. Which hallway statement should be corrected?

C. We can store the joinery there because the trim review is allowed.

Permission for the review does not authorize material storage in the hallway.

Return to the exercise, page 66

F / Guided speaking

1. Tuesday

Carpenter: Delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning.

Turn 1. Tuesday morning is the delivery slot, not a confirmed installation start.

2. released

Coordinator: The study has not been released for carpentry access.

Turn 2. The decorator has not released the study for the intended work.

3. 11:00

Carpenter: The hallway trim review is at 11:00.

Turn 3. Eleven o'clock is the separate trim-review time supplied in the case.

4. storage

Coordinator: The hallway is not available for material storage.

Turn 4. Storage is explicitly excluded even though the hallway review is allowed.

Return to the conversation, page 67

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved". Farah: "Please put that distinction in the coordination message. What would you say without blaming the decorator for a delay we haven't established?" Ben: [missing response] Farah: "Read the four statuses back separately, please. I want delivery, study access, review access, and storage to be unmistakable." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. That is the right logistics update to give. I am reporting the current release status, not a reason for it or a claim that another trade has missed a deadline.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Farah says: "All right. Please flag the unresolved coordination to me. The hallway review permission mustn't turn into a general storage or installation permission." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Farah says: "So the delivery is still Tuesday morning, even though we don't yet have a permitted storage arrangement? Please don't invent a new slot in the update." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Farah says: "Can the joinery wait in the hallway until the study is released? I'm asking before anyone puts that location on the delivery instructions." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 14. It connects Farah's preceding point with Farah's follow-up. Logistics update reports the actual arrangements and unresolved dependency without inventing a cause or blaming another trade.

Return to the exercise, page 67

07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which earlier statement must Luis correct?

D. All fronts are flush

Luis claimed all fronts were flush, which conflicts with the specific visible exception.

Return to the exercise, page 70

A2. What does Priya identify?

D. D3's left edge projects beyond the neighboring front

The supplied observation concerns D3's projecting left edge, without a measurement or cause.

Return to the exercise, page 70

A3. What should Luis do next in the conversation?

A. Correct the claim and record the specific observation for follow-up

The supported response is an explicit correction and accurate follow-up record, not a guessed remedy.

Return to the exercise, page 70

D / Response choices

D1. Which opening corrects the earlier claim?

D. I need to correct that: D3's left edge is not flush with the neighboring front.

The opening explicitly withdraws the inaccurate overall claim and identifies the exception.

Return to the exercise, page 74

D2. Which snag entry is precise?

D. D3 left edge projects beyond neighboring front; cause and remedy unassessed.

The entry preserves the component, side, reference surface, and unassessed cause and remedy.

Return to the exercise, page 74

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Edge extending beyond a stated reference surface. Which term fits?

C. projecting edge

A Not here. hinge: Joint allowing a door or panel to pivot. The usual combination is "identify the hinge".

B Not here. quality claim: Statement about the condition or standard of work. The usual combination is "qualify the quality claim".

C Correct. projecting edge: Edge extending beyond a stated reference surface. The usual combination is "describe the projecting edge".

D Not here. snag: Item requiring attention during a completion or quality review. The usual combination is "record a snag".

Return to the exercise, page 74

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Correcting the claim about drawer D3". Priya: "Is it a runner fault? I wondered whether adjusting the hardware would bring it back, but I don't know what's behind it." Luis: [missing response] Priya: "How far does it project? I can see the edge, but I haven't measured it, and I don't want my estimate repeated as a measurement." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The root cause hasn't been assessed. I can't call the runner defective or promise that a particular adjustment will correct the position.

A Correct. This is Luis's response in turn 6. It connects Priya's preceding point with Priya's follow-up. Root cause remains unassessed; the visible projection does not establish a runner defect or another explanation.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Priya says: "Thank you. I don't want the list to say wardrobe problem, though. Someone coming back needs to know which edge we're discussing." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Priya says: "How far does it project? I can see the edge, but I haven't measured it, and I don't want my estimate repeated as a measurement." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Priya says: "Can you tell me what will be done and when, or do those both have to wait for the follow-up assessment?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 74

E / Conversation

1. correction of record

Turn 2. Correction of record explicitly withdraws the inaccurate claim that all fronts are flush in light of the D3 observation.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. drawer front

Turn 4. Drawer front is D3's visible face, the specific component Priya wants recorded rather than a vague whole-wardrobe concern.

3. root cause

Turn 6. Root cause remains unassessed; the visible projection does not establish a runner defect or another explanation.

4. offset

Turn 8. Offset is the amount of displacement between the fronts; no measured value is supplied by the visible observation alone.

5. tolerance

Turn 10. Tolerance is the permitted variation under the relevant specification; no comparison with that requirement has been completed here.

6. snagging list

Turn 12. Snagging list records the specific D3 item for follow-up; it does not establish that every drawer has the same condition.

7. quality claim

Turn 14. Quality claim that all fronts were flush must be corrected rather than retained as a conflicting statement beside the new observation.

8. remedy

Turn 16. Remedy is the corrective action, which has not been determined; therefore no method or completion time can be promised here.

9. follow-up item

Turn 18. Follow-up item is the precise D3 left-edge projection, with cause and remedy left unassessed for the next review.

10. closeout status

Turn 20. Closeout status remains open for D3 because recording the observation and correcting a statement do not complete the necessary follow-up.

Return to the conversation, page 76

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which conclusion is unsupported?

D. A replacement runner is definitely required.

No assessment establishes that the runner caused the projection or needs replacement.

Return to the exercise, page 78

F2. What remains open after recording the item?

D. Cause, remedy, and any completion arrangement

Recording the observation does not determine the cause, repair, or completion timing.

Return to the exercise, page 78

F / Guided speaking

1. flush

Carpenter: I need to correct my claim that all fronts are flush.

Turn 1. Flush was the inaccurate overall claim contradicted by D3's projecting edge.

2. D3

Client: The specific drawer is D3.

Turn 2. D3 identifies the drawer that needs the recorded follow-up.

3. left

Carpenter: Its left edge projects beyond the neighboring front.

Turn 3. Left identifies the side of the visible projection in the case.

4. unassessed

Client: The cause and remedy remain unassessed.

Turn 4. Neither cause nor remedy has been determined by the observation alone.

Return to the conversation, page 79

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Correcting the claim about drawer D3". Priya: "Does correcting your earlier statement mean you're saying every drawer is wrong now? That's not what I'm asking you to report." Luis: [missing response] Priya: "Can you tell me what will be done and when, or do those both have to wait for the follow-up assessment?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. No. The quality claim is narrowed by this specific exception. We have identified D3; we haven't established that all the other fronts have the same issue.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Priya says: "So we can't call it within tolerance yet? Earlier I thought you were saying the whole installation had passed that comparison." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Luis's response in turn 14. It connects Priya's preceding point with Priya's follow-up. Quality claim that all fronts were flush must be corrected rather than retained as a conflicting statement beside the new observation.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Priya says: "Luis, you said all the fronts were flush. D3's left edge is sitting forward of the neighboring front. Can you check what you told me?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Priya says: "Please make sure it stays on the follow-up list. I don't want a general handover tick to hide this particular point." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 79

08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which documents does Daniel receive?

C. Cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet

The case confirms delivery of the cabinet drawings and the correct care sheet.

Return to the exercise, page 80

A2. What remains outstanding?

C. A replacement shelf pin cover that is due but not delivered

The replacement cover has not arrived, so that item remains open.

Return to the exercise, page 80

A3. What does Mina commit to?

B. Supplier follow-up and a Friday call, with no confirmed return visit

Mina owns supplier follow-up and promises the call, not a visit or delivery date.

Return to the exercise, page 80

D / Response choices

D1. Which handover summary is correct?

D. Drawings and care sheet received; cover outstanding; Mina follows up and calls Friday; visit unconfirmed.

The summary preserves completed documents, the open part, ownership, call, and unconfirmed visit.

Return to the exercise, page 84

D2. What does Mina's Friday commitment cover?

B. A phone call to Daniel

Mina explicitly commits to calling Friday, while delivery and attendance remain unconfirmed.

Return to the exercise, page 84

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Confirmation of the surface treatment a document applies to. Which term fits?

A. finish identification

A Correct. finish identification: Confirmation of the surface treatment a document applies to. The usual combination is "check finish identification".

B Not here. warranty document: Written terms describing the applicable warranty. The usual combination is "refer to the warranty document".

C Not here. due delivery: Expected arrival that has not necessarily occurred. The usual combination is "distinguish due delivery from receipt".

D Not here. handover record: Note of documents, completed work, and unresolved items at transfer. The usual combination is "update the handover record".

Return to the exercise, page 84

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Documents received, one cover outstanding". Daniel: "Who will chase the supplier? I'd prefer one named contact so I don't have to repeat the same question to several people." Mina: [missing response] Daniel: "Can you give me a firm time for the next update, even if the supplier hasn't confirmed the delivery by then?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I accept the supplier follow-up. I will contact the supplier about the cover, and the record should name me as the person responsible.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Daniel says: "I've received the cabinet drawings and care sheet. Before you leave, can we run through the missing cover and the follow-up?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Daniel says: "Thanks. I won't keep Friday free for a visit. Please make the written note just as clear for anyone else who picks this up." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 6. It connects Daniel's preceding point with Daniel's follow-up. Supplier follow-up is Mina's accepted responsibility for the outstanding cover, rather than an unassigned action for someone else.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Daniel says: "Then I'll keep the finish-care instructions separate from the warranty terms. Neither document confirms that the missing part has arrived." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 84

E / Conversation

1. handover pack

Turn 2. Handover pack includes the cabinet drawings and correct finish care sheet already received; the replacement cover remains a separate open item.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. part receipt

Turn 4. Part receipt has not occurred because the replacement shelf pin cover is due but has not been delivered.

3. supplier follow-up

Turn 6. Supplier follow-up is Mina's accepted responsibility for the outstanding cover, rather than an unassigned action for someone else.

4. callback commitment

Turn 8. Callback commitment is Mina's explicit promise to call Friday, distinct from a request or a confirmed delivery arrangement.

5. appointment confirmation

Turn 10. Appointment confirmation for a return visit has not been given; Friday identifies the promised call only.

6. commitment boundary

Turn 12. Commitment boundary limits the Friday promise to a call, without expanding it into delivery or physical attendance.

7. warranty document

Turn 14. Warranty document remains the source of the applicable terms; Mina does not add or remove coverage through this handover conversation.

8. care sheet

Turn 16. Care sheet contains the relevant finish-care information and is already received; it is distinct from warranty terms and the open-part record.

9. handover record

Turn 18. Handover record must distinguish received documents from the undelivered cover and preserve Mina's follow-up and Friday-call commitment.

10. open-item tracker

Turn 20. Open-item tracker keeps the replacement cover unresolved until the actual outcome supports closure, rather than closing it because documents were supplied.

Return to the conversation, page 86

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which warranty statement is appropriate?

D. The terms remain those in the supplied document.

The case authorizes no change to the supplied warranty terms in either direction.

Return to the exercise, page 88

F2. What is insufficient evidence to close the cover item?

D. Receipt of the drawings and care sheet alone

Receiving documents does not establish delivery, fitting, or resolution of the replacement cover.

Return to the exercise, page 88

F / Guided speaking

1. received

Owner: The drawings and correct care sheet are received.

Turn 1. The case confirms that both documents have reached the owner.

2. delivered

Lead: The replacement cover has not been delivered.

Turn 2. The cover is due but has not arrived, so it remains outstanding.

3. Mina

Owner: Mina owns the supplier follow-up.

Turn 3. Mina explicitly accepts responsibility for contacting the supplier about the cover.

4. Friday

Lead: I will call Friday; the return visit is not confirmed.

Turn 4. Friday is the committed call date, not an agreed return visit.

Return to the conversation, page 89

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Documents received, one cover outstanding". Daniel: "One more thing: does today's conversation change the warranty? I have the document and don't want to rely on a different verbal promise." Mina: [missing response] Daniel: "Then I'll keep the finish-care instructions separate from the warranty terms. Neither document confirms that the missing part has arrived." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. The warranty document remains the reference. I am not adding broader coverage verbally or changing the terms supplied with your records.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Daniel says: "Who will chase the supplier? I'd prefer one named contact so I don't have to repeat the same question to several people." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 14. It connects Daniel's preceding point with Daniel's follow-up. Warranty document remains the source of the applicable terms; Mina does not add or remove coverage through this handover conversation.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Daniel says: "Thanks. I won't keep Friday free for a visit. Please make the written note just as clear for anyone else who picks this up." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Daniel says: "I've received the cabinet drawings and care sheet. Before you leave, can we run through the missing cover and the follow-up?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 89

Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Opening measured at the specified completed surfaces. Which term fits?

A. finished opening

A Correct. finished opening: Opening measured at the specified completed surfaces. The usual combination is "identify the finished opening".

B Not here. reference face: Surface from which a dimension is measured. The usual combination is "identify the reference face".

C Not here. head: Upper horizontal member or part of an opening. The usual combination is "identify the frame head".

D Not here. door schedule: Drawing or document listing specified doors and their attributes. The usual combination is "check the door schedule".

Return to the exercise, page 24

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Strongly visible wood pattern. Which term fits?

A. pronounced grain

A Correct. pronounced grain: Strongly visible wood pattern. The usual combination is "describe pronounced grain".

B Not here. solid oak: Material made from oak wood rather than an oak surface veneer over a core. The usual combination is "specify solid oak trim".

C Not here. finish sample: Example showing a proposed surface appearance. The usual combination is "review the finish sample".

D Not here. selection status: Whether a choice has been made. The usual combination is "confirm the selection status".

Return to the exercise, page 24

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "What does 900 millimeters describe?". Hana: "Has anyone already bought a door against that number? I'd rather raise it now than discover it doesn't give us the passage we need." Ellis: [missing response] Hana: "Can Priya settle the meaning? She prepared the design, and I'd like her to understand why I'm asking about the space." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. No door is ordered, and the order size isn't confirmed. We're clarifying the drawing before purchasing, not changing an existing order.

A Correct. This is Ellis's response in turn 10. It connects Hana's preceding point with Hana's follow-up. Order size is not established by the ambiguous note, and no door has been ordered in this case.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Hana says: "And we're not confirming that the doorway meets a particular access requirement today? I don't want to pass that on as settled." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Hana says: "Right, I'm interested in the gap I can actually use, not the width of the door leaf. Have I been reading the wrong measurement?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Hana says: "Please don't change 900 to a different number in the message. I'm asking what it means, not instructing her to redesign it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two oak samples, different trade-offs". Oliver: "Can you keep the finish details and prices as outstanding questions? They matter to the decision as well as the grain and lead time." Mei: [missing response] Oliver: "Let me read that back: A, solid oak, stronger grain, ten days; B, veneered, more uniform, four days. Neither has an installation booking." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. We can keep those as separate questions before sample approval. Nothing in this discussion establishes a finish specification, a price, or a guarantee about future product performance.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Oliver says: "A's grain stands out much more against this wall color. B looks quieter. Is that just what we're seeing in these particular pieces?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Mei's response in turn 18. It connects Oliver's preceding point with Oliver's follow-up. Sample approval has not been given; the missing comparisons and Oliver's final choice remain unresolved.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Oliver says: "Both shapes look right for the study. Before I choose, what is actually different between these samples apart from the price, which I haven't seen?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Oliver says: "Let me read that back: A, solid oak, stronger grain, ten days; B, veneered, more uniform, four days. Neither has an installation booking." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Defined visible gap or exposed setback between adjacent components. Which term fits?

A. reveal

A Correct. reveal: Defined visible gap or exposed setback between adjacent components. The usual combination is "confirm the reveal dimension".

B Not here. review deadline: Time by which a review is due. The usual combination is "state the review deadline".

C Not here. fabrication: Manufacture of components or assemblies. The usual combination is "clarify before fabrication".

D Not here. superseded drawing: Earlier drawing replaced by a later authorized issue. The usual combination is "identify a superseded drawing".

Return to the exercise, page 46

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Deterioration of wood through biological action. Which term fits?

B. timber decay

A Not here. inspection access: Ability to reach or view an area for examination. The usual combination is "confirm inspection access".

B Correct. timber decay: Deterioration of wood through biological action. The usual combination is "avoid diagnosing timber decay".

C Not here. subfloor: Supporting floor layer beneath the finished floor covering. The usual combination is "describe the exposed subfloor".

D Not here. structural finding: Conclusion reached through appropriate structural assessment. The usual combination is "distinguish a structural finding".

Return to the exercise, page 46

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Two oak samples, different trade-offs". Oliver: "That makes B six days quicker on the quote. I still prefer A's grain, so I'm not ready to choose on timing alone." Mei: [missing response] Oliver: "And I wouldn't lose this edge shape by choosing B? The study trim needs the profile we've already discussed." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Exactly. Your visual preference and the timing are separate considerations. We can compare them without deciding that one sample is better in every respect.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Oliver says: "Do we have prices or durability information yet? I don't want to assume veneered automatically means cheaper or less hard-wearing." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Oliver says: "A's grain stands out much more against this wall color. B looks quieter. Is that just what we're seeing in these particular pieces?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Oliver says: "I'm leaning toward A, but please don't order it on that basis. I still need the missing details before I approve anything." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Mei's response in turn 10. It connects Oliver's preceding point with Oliver's follow-up. Visual preference concerns the appearance Oliver favors and remains one consideration alongside the stated timing and construction.

Return to the exercise, page 46

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Staining is not a structural finding". Theo: "Can you read the location back? There are two laundry doors, and I don't want the person coming out to review the wrong patch." Nia: [missing response] Theo: "Yes, that's the area. Please give Sam the question as well as the observation, so it doesn't become just a cosmetic stain report." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. The note identifies the exposed subfloor beside this laundry doorway, with the staining shown in the referral record. It also states that the joists are concealed.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Theo says: "Yes, that's the area. Please give Sam the question as well as the observation, so it doesn't become just a cosmetic stain report." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Theo says: "Could it be coming from the laundry? That was my first thought because it's so close to the doorway." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Theo says: "Would it be reasonable to say the joists are probably fine until someone finds damage? Or is that going too far as well?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 18. It connects Theo's preceding point with Theo's follow-up. Laundry doorway is the specific location of the observation, allowing the referral to identify the relevant area accurately.

Return to the exercise, page 46

Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Fixed seating integrated into a room or fitted assembly. Which term fits?

B. built-in bench

A Not here. separate quotation: Distinct price proposal for specified extra work. The usual combination is "arrange a separate quotation".

B Correct. built-in bench: Fixed seating integrated into a room or fitted assembly. The usual combination is "request a built-in bench".

C Not here. finish requirement: Specified surface appearance or treatment. The usual combination is "clarify the finish requirement".

D Not here. book matching: Pairing consecutive veneer leaves by alternating their faces for mirrored grain. The usual combination is "specify book matching".

Return to the exercise, page 68

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Check or discussion of the specified trim details. Which term fits?

B. trim review

A Not here. area readiness: Whether a location is prepared for the intended activity. The usual combination is "confirm area readiness".

B Correct. trim review: Check or discussion of the specified trim details. The usual combination is "attend the trim review".

C Not here. equilibrium moisture content: Wood moisture at balance with surrounding temperature and humidity. The usual combination is "distinguish equilibrium moisture content".

D Not here. joinery: Fitted woodwork or related manufactured components for a project. The usual combination is "coordinate the joinery delivery".

Return to the exercise, page 68

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Staining is not a structural finding". Theo: "Who should look into it? I'd like someone qualified to assess it before I'm told the floor needs replacing." Nia: [missing response] Theo: "Does that mean replacement is likely? I'm trying to work out whether we need to budget for a much bigger job." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I'll contact Sam to arrange a qualified assessor. The referral will give the location, what is exposed, and what we cannot currently see.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Theo says: "So you can record the stain, but not my guess about what caused it as though it's a finding?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Nia's response in turn 10. It connects Theo's preceding point with Theo's follow-up. Qualified assessor is the appropriate person to examine the relevant concern; no completed assessment or finding exists yet.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Theo says: "Nia, this dark patch by the laundry door looks worrying. Is that rot in the joists, or am I jumping to conclusions?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Theo says: "I thought what we're looking at might be the joists themselves. Are those different from this exposed layer?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 68

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved". Farah: "Do we know when the study will be released? If not, keep that unknown rather than using eleven o'clock as a convenient estimate." Ben: [missing response] Farah: "All right. Please flag the unresolved coordination to me. The hallway review permission mustn't turn into a general storage or installation permission." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Yes. The schedule dependency is still the study release. No alternative storage, changed delivery slot, or installation start has been established in this update.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Farah says: "Is the decorator finished with the study? I don't want the delivery confirmation to be read as permission for the installers to enter that room." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 18. It connects Farah's preceding point with Farah's follow-up. Schedule dependency is the unresolved study access, which remains distinct from the already confirmed delivery and review arrangements.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Farah says: "Then what exactly is booked for eleven in the hallway? The word access in the message is a bit too broad for me." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Farah says: "Can the joinery wait in the hallway until the study is released? I'm asking before anyone puts that location on the delivery instructions." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 68

Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Adjacent visible face used as a comparison. Which term fits?

C. neighboring front

A Not here. tolerance: Permitted variation under an applicable specification. The usual combination is "check the applicable tolerance".

B Not here. drawer runner: Mechanism or support guiding a drawer's movement. The usual combination is "inspect the drawer runner".

C Correct. neighboring front: Adjacent visible face used as a comparison. The usual combination is "compare the neighboring front".

D Not here. specific exception: Identified case that contradicts a general claim. The usual combination is "acknowledge the specific exception".

Return to the exercise, page 90

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Matter not yet completed, delivered, or resolved. Which term fits?

C. outstanding item

A Not here. return visit: Later attendance at the property. The usual combination is "arrange a return visit".

B Not here. part receipt: Confirmation that a component has physically arrived. The usual combination is "verify part receipt".

C Correct. outstanding item: Matter not yet completed, delivered, or resolved. The usual combination is "retain an outstanding item".

D Not here. handover pack: Collection of documents supplied at a project handover. The usual combination is "confirm the handover pack".

Return to the exercise, page 90

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Delivery confirmed, study access unresolved". Farah: "So the delivery is still Tuesday morning, even though we don't yet have a permitted storage arrangement? Please don't invent a new slot in the update." Ben: [missing response] Farah: "And we can't advertise Tuesday installation just because the material is arriving? The room release is still the missing part." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I have not changed the confirmed delivery. Tuesday morning is still the stated slot. The update flags the mismatch without claiming that a replacement plan exists.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Farah says: "All right. Please flag the unresolved coordination to me. The hallway review permission mustn't turn into a general storage or installation permission." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Farah says: "Can the joinery wait in the hallway until the study is released? I'm asking before anyone puts that location on the delivery instructions." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Ben's response in turn 10. It connects Farah's preceding point with Farah's follow-up. Confirmed delivery remains Tuesday morning; reporting the access conflict does not itself reschedule the supplier.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Farah says: "Then what exactly is booked for eleven in the hallway? The word access in the message is a bit too broad for me." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 90

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Documents received, one cover outstanding". Daniel: "Could you read back what is complete and what remains open? I'd like the documents acknowledged without the part being marked done." Mina: [missing response] Daniel: "That's clear. Please keep the cover open until its actual outcome is confirmed, and call Friday as agreed even if the delivery is still unresolved." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. The handover record says drawings and correct care sheet received; replacement cover outstanding; supplier follow-up owned by Mina; Friday callback committed; return date unconfirmed.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Daniel says: "Then I'll keep the finish-care instructions separate from the warranty terms. Neither document confirms that the missing part has arrived." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Daniel says: "I've received the cabinet drawings and care sheet. Before you leave, can we run through the missing cover and the follow-up?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Daniel says: "Thanks. I won't keep Friday free for a visit. Please make the written note just as clear for anyone else who picks this up." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Mina's response in turn 18. It connects Daniel's preceding point with Daniel's follow-up. Handover record must distinguish received documents from the undelivered cover and preserve Mina's follow-up and Friday-call commitment.

Return to the exercise, page 90

Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. kerf

Turn 2. Kerf is the width of material removed by a cut; the supplied worksheet allows three millimeters for each of three cuts.

2. finished length

Turn 4. Each required finished piece remains 995 millimeters; adding a material allowance does not authorize shortening that dimension.

3. residual

Turn 6. The supplied requirements total 2,994 millimeters, leaving six from 3,000; fifteen would ignore nine millimeters consumed by the cuts.

4. usable length

Turn 8. The 3,000-millimeter figure is explicitly after end preparation; applying an additional invented end allowance would change the supplied estimate.

5. shortfall

Turn 10. Three times 998 plus three times 3 equals 3,003 millimeters, three more than the stated 3,000 available.

6. cut list

Turn 12. The cut list specifies quantities and finished dimensions; an unresolved material shortage calls for review, not an unauthorized size change.

Return to the conversation, page 93

Transfer exchange

1. 2396

Coordinator: The two finished lengths total 2396 millimeters.

Turn 1. Two times 1,198 equals 2,396 millimeters before allowing for the cuts.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. six

Estimator: The two cuts consume six millimeters.

Turn 2. Two cuts at three millimeters each consume six millimeters in the stated worksheet.

3. 2402

Coordinator: The total material requirement is 2402 millimeters.

Turn 3. Adding the six-millimeter allowance to 2,396 gives 2,402, not 2,400.

4. two

Estimator: That is two millimeters more than the usable stock.

Turn 4. The 2,402-millimeter requirement exceeds 2,400 by two; the finished dimensions cannot be silently shortened.

Return to the conversation, page 96

Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. book matching

Turn 2. Book matching alternates consecutive veneer leaves by turning them over, producing paired mirror-like grain patterns rather than simple repeats.

2. slip matching

Turn 4. Slip matching places successive leaves alongside one another in the same face orientation to repeat the grain pattern; N is not the approved mockup.

3. viewing direction

Turn 6. Both the required elevation order and photographed order are specified from the finished front, removing a front-versus-back reversal explanation.

4. panel sequence

Turn 8. The specified sequence is P11-P12-P13 from the finished front; the recorded P13-P12-P11 layout reverses the outer panels.

5. orientation

Turn 10. Orientation includes which face and direction a panel is intended to present; the label-order discrepancy alone does not authorize turning or altering panels.

6. approved mockup

Turn 12. Mockup M is the stated approved reference; N is an unapproved slip-matched alternative, not an equally authorized selection.

Return to the conversation, page 98

Transfer exchange

1. P22

Designer: The required center panel is P22 .

Turn 1. The elevation puts P22 in the center even though the recorded layout places it on the right.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. P23

Coordinator: The required right panel is P23 .

Turn 2. P23 belongs on the right; its presence in the center is a sequence discrepancy.

3. book matching

Designer: Q specifies book matching .

Turn 3. Alternately turning consecutive leaves creates the paired mirror-like pattern described in Q.

4. slip matching

Coordinator: Same-face grain repeats describe slip matching instead.

Turn 4. Slip matching repeats successive leaves alongside each other without the alternating face turnover described for Q.

Return to the conversation, page 101

Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. moisture content

Turn 2. Wood moisture content here is water mass divided by oven-dry wood mass, expressed as a percentage, not the absolute grams of water alone.

2. dry-mass basis

Turn 4. The supplied formula uses the 120-gram oven-dry mass for A; dividing by the original mass would answer a different question.

3. percentage

Turn 6. B is 12.5 percent and A is 10 percent on the same dry-mass basis, despite B containing fewer absolute grams of water.

4. screening result

Turn 8. A meets the fictional 8-12 percent sample interval; B at 12.5 percent does not, without establishing a cause or overall installation fitness.

5. individual limit

Turn 10. The stated requirement applies to each sample, so averaging 10 and 12.5 to 11.25 cannot erase B's individual result above twelve.

6. Relative humidity

Turn 12. Relative humidity describes the surrounding air, whereas wood moisture content describes water relative to dry wood mass; their percentages are not interchangeable.

Return to the conversation, page 103

Transfer exchange

1. 15

Coordinator: C contains 15 grams of water in the reported calculation.

Turn 1. The original 165 grams minus 150 grams oven-dry gives fifteen grams of water.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. 10

Lead: C has 10 percent moisture on the dry-mass basis.

Turn 2. Fifteen divided by the 150-gram dry mass, multiplied by one hundred, is ten percent.

3. 13

Coordinator: D has 13 percent moisture on the same basis.

Turn 3. The thirteen-gram difference divided by one hundred dry grams gives thirteen percent.

4. above

Lead: D is above the stated screening interval.

Turn 4. Thirteen exceeds the fictional upper limit of twelve; C's passing result cannot make D meet it.

Return to the conversation, page 106

Find a phrase by purpose

Confirming openings and measurement references

Locate the note: The hall drawing labels the door opening as 900 millimeters.

Clarify the assumption: Are you reading that as the clear passage width?

Name the ambiguity: The note does not say rough or finished opening.

Full phrase bank, page 7

Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

Open the comparison: Both samples match the requested profile.

Describe A's construction: Sample A is solid oak.

Describe B's construction: Sample B is oak-veneered trim.

Full phrase bank, page 17

Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

Flag the issue: I found a conflict at the cabinet end panel.

Cite the first view: Elevation C4 revision B shows a 20-millimeter reveal.

Cite the second view: Section S2 revision B shows 15 millimeters.

Full phrase bank, page 29

Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

Name the observation: I can see dark staining on the exposed subfloor.

Locate it precisely: It is beside the laundry doorway.

Acknowledge the concern: I understand why you are asking about the joists.

Full phrase bank, page 39

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Separating requested extras from agreed work

Acknowledge the idea: I understand you would like a built-in bench as well.

Name the agreement: The current scope is replacing the bedroom skirting only.

State the exclusion: Decorating is excluded from this booking.

Full phrase bank, page 51

Coordinating access and other trades

Start with delivery: The joinery delivery is confirmed for Tuesday morning.

Separate the room status: The study has not been released for carpentry access.

Name the dependency: We still need the decorator's access release.

Full phrase bank, page 61

Reviewing fit, appearance, and snagging

Correct the earlier statement: I need to correct what I said about all the fronts being flush.

Acknowledge the exception: You are right to point out D3.

Name the component: The observation concerns drawer D3.

Full phrase bank, page 73

Handing over records and return visits

Confirm the documents: You have the cabinet drawings and the correct finish care sheet.

Identify the open item: The replacement shelf pin cover is still outstanding.

State receipt accurately: It is due, but it has not been delivered.

Full phrase bank, page 83

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References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Carpenters.

Occupational context for reading plans, discussing measurements and materials, installation work, and client communication. No employment forecasts or credential requirements are reproduced. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.bls.gov/ooh/construction-and-extraction/carpenters.htm

[2] Architectural Woodwork Institute. AWI 100: Manufacturer / Supplier Responsibility.

Context for shop drawings, material samples, explicit change requests, and coordinated review. Fictional drawing conflicts and review times are not requirements stated by this source. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://awinet.org/standards/submittals/requirements-category/manufacturer-supplier-responsibility/

[3] Andersen Windows and Doors. Window and Door Glossary.

Background terminology for openings, frames, trim, and door components. No product-specific dimensions, installation allowances, or compliance claims are transferred to the cases. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.andersenwindows.com/support/window-door-glossary

[4] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Woodworking: Hazards and Solutions.

Context for respecting trained roles and actual safety controls. The book provides no machine-operation, chemical-use, or concealed-condition assessment procedure. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.osha.gov/woodworking/hazards-solutions

> **Companion course**
>
> The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.
>
> https://englishladder.com/efsp-carpentry-remodeling.html

Precise details. Clear agreements.

Eight practical conversations: clarify a dimension, compare trim samples, resolve conflicting drawings, report concealed-condition concerns, separate extras, coordinate trades, correct a fit claim, and hand over an outstanding part.

Confirming openings and measurement references

The only established figure is 900 millimeters in an unclear opening note. Rough opening, finished opening, door size, and clear passage are not interchangeable labels. No conversion or allowance is supplied, and no door has been ordered.

Selecting timber, trim, and visible finishes

Sample A has pronounced grain and a ten-day quoted lead time. Sample B has a more uniform appearance and a four-day quote. Both match the profile. These are sample-specific facts, not universal claims about solid oak and veneered products.

Reading details and resolving drawing conflicts

The difference is five millimeters, but calculating that difference does not identify the correct reveal. Both C4 and S2 are revision B and refer to the same panel. Neither sheet is established as superseded or authoritative over the other.

Discussing concealed conditions without guessing

The visible staining is on the exposed subfloor, not on visible joists. Theo raises possible rot as a question. The joists are concealed and structural condition has not been assessed, so neither decay nor structural soundness is established.

Phil Stilwell

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